The Ontology of Coexistence

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The question: What is Existence? What exists? Does what exists begin at some time? Does the individual self (*jeevan*) begin or end with the body? Is the world finally real?

This study examines those questions in Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism), as presented by Shri A. Nagraj, and compares its answers with Advaita Vedanta and selected modern philosophical and scientific approaches to physical reality, consciousness, and selfhood. Full treatment of time (*kaal*), *trikaalabadh*, and spacetime physics is in *Nature of Time*; here only the core claim is stated — that *kaal* is duration of unit-activity and *satta* is timeless as ground (§1.6.4).

Standpoint and scope

These studies are written from the standpoint of a scientist and technologist — someone trained to graduate-level physics and mathematics, at home with contemporary cosmology, quantum theory, conservation laws, and the logic of formal models.

From that background, a familiar picture of nature is hard to avoid: consciousness appears as something the brain does — an epiphenomenon, functional outcome, or emergent property of particular configurations of very large numbers of physical particles. Modern physics and cognitive science are powerful on mechanism, prediction, and public evidence; yet the hard problem of consciousness, the status of the self, and the reality of value remain fiercely contested. The standpoint taken here does not treat those gaps as settled in favour of matter-only reductionism.

Those open questions motivate the comparative inquiry, but exposition follows the darshan's own order. Madhyasth Darshan's ontology is stated on its own terms first (§1), then Advaita Vedanta (§2), then modern philosophy and science (§§3–4), and comparison and critical review (§§5–6). Physics and the physicalist default are not narrated as if §1 were written outward from neuroscience; they enter as one leg of parallel testing once MD's definitions are on the table.

The study reads the primary texts carefully, states what follows from the darshan itself, and compares it in parallel with physics and the natural sciences, Advaita Vedanta, and modern Western philosophy (especially philosophy of mind). Advaita Vedanta comes before modern physicalism because it is the nearest non-physicalist rival sharing Indian vocabulary, even though the inquiry starts from the physicalist default. Physics and mathematics are one leg of that comparison, not the only one.

The aim is rigorous comparative understanding — testing definitions, internal consistency, and fit with public knowledge — not persuasion or devotional endorsement.

The study develops Madhyasth Darshan's ontology — saturation, causation, unit structure, the sentience threshold, and conservation — then compares it with Advaita Vedanta and selected modern views. It does not claim that physics, neuroscience, or comparative argument alone establish immortal *jeevan*, constitutional completeness, or continuity across bodily death. Where traditions use different criteria of knowing, the dispute is treated as partially incommensurable (§5.3.5); open points are collected in §6.2. These topical studies state the philosophy in clear, checkable prose first; a separate formal mathematical treatment may follow once the definitions are stable across the series.

Several claims the ontology depends on are argued fully elsewhere. The full-knowability thesis is developed in *Knowledge, Knower, and Known* §1.11. Post-death continuity and evidence are treated in §§1.8, 6.2.3, and §6.4. Ethics, society, spiritual practice, and the full *kaal* treatment belong in linked studies such as *Nature of Time*.

The primary base for this study is three English translations by Rakesh Gupta (MVD, SB, JV). Relationship and value structure, cyclical economics, and some method vocabulary may be fuller in untranslated Hindi works such as *Manav Vyavahar Darshan* and *Avartansheel Arthshastra*, so coverage claims here are scoped to the translated corpus unless noted. Progression vocabulary includes *niyati-kram* and *niyati-vidhi* (named in *Paribhasha Samhita*; expounded here from MVD/SB/JV where those translations carry the doctrine).

Institutional self-governance, *dharma-niti*, *rajya-niti*, public justice, and statutory social order belong in the planned study *Governance Justice and Undivided Society* and related social studies. How to Form Self-Sustaining Organizations applies the assembly template in concrete social forms — it does not replace the ontological account here.

Regulation, law, and justice are treated ontologically in §§1.11–1.12. Terms are defined in the essay where they first arise; a consolidated glossary keyed to §§1–4 appears in the Appendix.

1. The Madhyasth Darshan Answer

Madhyasth Darshan reads existence as coexistence — the ever-present togetherness of Omnipotence (*satta*) and countless units of nature, insentient (*jada*) and sentient (*chaitanya*), each saturated in that ground. Nothing stands apart from it: units are real, bounded, and soaked in *satta* at every order, and change unfolds through their activity within that bond.

That picture is the basis for values in relationships at every level. Complementarity and fulfilment are not afterthoughts imposed on a value-neutral world; they are built into how units recognise and respond to one another in coexistence. At the human scale the same logic opens toward a tradition of undivided society and universal orderliness — human life lived fearlessly, in prosperity, with trust, and in coexistence with one another and with nature.

1.1 Coexistence: Omnipresence and units

Every bounded unit in coexistence carries a definite constitution, inherent energy from saturation, and lawful modes of interaction with other units — all within a pervasive ground that does not itself act.

The translation prints Omnipotence for *satta*; this study uses Omnipresence in prose and keeps the translation's word inside quotes (Editorial Notes). SB states the two-pole structure most directly:

> **"What is evident is that consciousness and matter are inseparably present. Upon examining their fundamental nature, we learn that all of existence is essentially nature (matter) saturated in Omnipotence (consciousness). Here, 'seeing' is intended in the sense of understanding. Since nature saturated in Omnipotence is inseparably present, existence itself is eternally manifest in the form of coexistence."**
> *- SB, p. 48*

Existence has two inseparable aspects. Omnipresence (*satta* / *vyapak*) is formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, and immeasurable — actionless energy (*kriya-shunya urja*) that performs no actions yet permeates existence as the ground through which units are energized, regulated, and conserved (SB, pp. 48–49). SB lists several English names for the same *satta* — Uniform Energy, Space (*shunya*), Knowledge (*gyan*), Consciousness, and Absolute Energy among others (SB, p. 48); no single word covers all of them. Consciousness and Knowledge here do not mean a mind that knows; sentience as the activity of a knower belongs to *jeevan*, not to Omnipresence itself (Editorial Notes).

Units of nature are the formful, active, countable entities within nature — the saturated whole of formful existence. Each unit is bounded from six directions, surrounded, submerged, and soaked in Omnipresence, with form, properties, essential nature, *dharma*, and orderliness (SB, p. 48; MVD, pp. 11, 34). Realisation Knowledge (*anubhav jnan*) names that ontological given.

Three structural features complete the picture. *Satta* and units never existed as separate poles — separation of unit from saturated fullness "never happens" (SB, p. 70; JV, p. 18). Omnipresence has no absent place, even where no local unit appears (SB, pp. 48, 62, 69). Units are distinct from one another by boundaries within saturation, not by leaving the ground: inter-unit distance is held in formless existence — *satta* as Space (*shunya*) between bounded wholes (SB, pp. 57, 59, 79) — which provisions the conditions for mutual recognition. Omnipresence is *sthitipurn* (state-complete): without motion, wave, or pressure. Nature saturated in it is *sthitishil* (state-dynamic): unit-activity, development, and awakening alone constitute change (SB, pp. 50, 68–69).

1.2 Saturation: the ground–unit bond

Coexistence is not inert juxtaposition of ground and units; every formful unit is saturated — soaked, submerged, and surrounded (*samprikt*) — in Omnipresence (SB, pp. 48–49). Saturation is the ever-present ontological bond between formless *satta* and each formful unit. Omnipresence does not act, transform, or be consumed in saturating a unit.

One way to picture the bond — illustrative, not an identity — is a living cell in a nutrient medium, or a sponge fully soaked in water: the unit remains surrounded, permeated, and sustained through the medium, not drained from a finite store. Though actionless and non-physical, *satta* permeates and energizes every unit. Inherent energy resides in each unit as a consequence of coexistence with that field; it is not an active force propagated from the ground as efficient cause.

From that saturated, bounded plurality, three ontological endowments follow in every unit.

The first is recognition capability for the complementarity that already exists in coexistence. Saturated units stand in mutuality; reciprocity and give–take are eternally established — complementarity is not created by recognition but given in the bond (SB, pp. 49–50, 53). Bounded plurality within saturation provisions mutual recognition (SB, pp. 50, 57, 62): units can recognise one another because complementarity is a perpetual condition of coexistence. Through saturation, *satta* does not push units as an external agent but endows each unit with the basis of capacity (*kshamata*), ability (*yogyata*), and receptivity (*patrata*) to participate in relationships at its order — a gift present in the unit from coexistence (SB, pp. 57, 62, 79; MVD, p. 62).

The second endowment is activeness in units. Through saturation, every unit has inherent energy in it:

> **"Every unit in its atomic state is active as orderliness, because it has inherent energy due to being saturated in Omnipotence."**
> *- SB, p. 69*
>
> **"Unit + Energy fullness = Activeness."**
> *- SB, p. 69*

Basic impulsion is each unit's inherent drive to be active, given saturation — not an external push. SB and MVD state the reciprocal structure of manifestation:

> **"Thus, without basic impulsion, the energy remains unmanifest, and without the energy, there is no basic impulsion."**
> *- SB, p. 62*
>
> **"Without absolute energy, there is no basic impulsion in matter, and without matter, absolute energy is not revealed. Nature is eternally present in absolute energy."**
> *- MVD, p. 40*

Through saturation, *satta* endows each unit with inherent forcefulness and basic impulsion (SB, p. 57). *Satta* is actionless in itself, yet called energy because unit-activity manifests through basic impulsion. Activeness is not activity of an isolated unit: every unit is always active along with contact in its mutuality (SB, p. 62). That activeness appears as the inseparable triad effort, motion, and result (*shram–gati–parinam*) — how all change is unit-activity in reciprocity (SB, pp. 53, 58, 69; MVD, p. 40). Relative energy does not become apparent without mutuality of units (MVD, p. 40).

> **"Since nature is eternally active within existence, every activity has inseparable effort, motion and result."**
> *- SB, p. 53*

The third endowment is inherent regulation. Saturation is where a unit gets regulatory order in it, alongside activeness and forcefulness (SB, p. 57) — not from an outside push. Regulation manifests as law and orderliness.

Mutual dependence for manifestation means that the ground's uniform energy and unit-activity always appear together. You do not get one without the other. Neither pole creates the other's existence — only its manifestation.

Together, these three endowments ground a unit's completeness drive: each unit is oriented toward development, activated by conducive environments and naturalness (SB, pp. 50–51).

1.3 What every unit is

Each unit is a whole along with its environment (SB, p. 13); the four aspects below name what every such whole is, at every order.

Every saturated unit carries the same four inseparable aspects — form, properties, essential nature, and *dharma* — regardless of order. They are not optional descriptors; they are what each unit is as a participant in coexistence (MVD, pp. 50–51).

Form (*roop*) is shared across all orders — shape, volume, and density by which a bounded unit is individuated (MVD, pp. 50, 112).

Properties (*gun*) name the effects units have on one another in mutuality, differentiated as generative, degenerative, and mediative — assisting creation, dissolution, and sustainment (MVD, pp. 50–51).

Essential nature (*svabhav* — Editorial Notes) is how the usefulness of a unit's properties participates in its order (MVD, pp. 50–51, 112).

Dharma names what a unit cannot be separated from — its innateness and fulfilment (SB, p. 50). Since existence is coexistence, indestructibility itself is the ultimate *dharma*.

SB opens with three companion facts:

> **“Each unit is a whole along with its environment.”**
> *- SB, p. 13*
>
> **“Each unit is orderliness with its ness and participates in overall orderliness.”**
> *- SB, p. 13*
>
> **“Each unit moves towards ‘development’ in its natural state and ‘decline’ in its excited state.”**
> *- SB, p. 14*

Unit + environment = the unit as a whole signifies continuity (SB, p. 51). *Ness* is what makes a unit the kind of unit it is — its distinctive way of being, shown through essential nature when it is in its natural state (SB, p. 54).

In its natural state, a unit moves toward development — fulfilment aligned with its innateness; in its excited state, toward decline (SB, pp. 14–15). Complementarity — given in coexistence and established through saturation’s recognition capability — appears here as reciprocal exchange within the natural state: after give and take, both parties reinstate satisfaction or natural motion (*svabhav gati*) (SB, p. 59). When all relationships are recognised and fulfilled, the unit is at ease in its natural state — no relational shortfall remains.

Participation means recognising and fulfilling — observable even in the physicochemical realm, where components within an atom recognise and fulfil one another (SB, p. 123). Endeavour aligned with a unit’s innateness moves toward fulfilment; endeavour against it gives rise to problems (MVD, p. 112).

JV illustrates definite conduct: a peepal tree maintains its conduct with all its fruits, seeds, and leaves exhibiting peepal’s properties, intrinsic nature, and *dharma* (JV, p. 113). Harmony among the four aspects is what MVD calls the essence of coexistence itself (MVD, p. 21).

1.4 Units in relationships

Nothing in nature is isolated — “nothing is isolated – that is the principle” (JV, p. 43). Existence holds relations between units, and it is in those relations that complementarity is actualised as value in mutuality (SB, p. 53). Complementarity here is not merely give–take reciprocity in physicochemical exchange; it is the whole structure by which units reciprocate essentiality. Relationships are where complementarity is predetermined toward completeness; the unit’s main drive is to recognise and fulfil them.

MVD defines a relationship as “the mutuality where expectations are predetermined in the sense of completeness” (MVD, p. 62), and contrasts it with association — “the mutuality where expectations are voluntary” (MVD, p. 61). Neighbours who share a wall have an association; parent and child stand in a relationship with expectations toward completeness.

Essentiality in every order is value — what units reciprocate and mutually recognise in mutuality:

> **“Entire beingness implies the essentiality of units in every plane and order. Essentiality refers to value… It is values that are reciprocated and mutually recognised, as complementarity, mutual recognition, and impression occur only in mutuality.”**
> *- SB, p. 50*

Value (*mulya*) is not one undifferentiated category. At every order, object values — utility (*upyogita*), the usefulness of natural abundance made available through labour, and art (*kala*), aesthetic enhancement that layers convenience on that usefulness — operate wherever production and exchange occur (MVD p. 306; JV pp. 138, 123). At the knowledge order, four further kinds presuppose *jeevan*: internal *jeevan* harmonies (happiness, peace, contentment, bliss); human values (the six *svabhav* qualities of the knowledge order); established relationship values (care, trust, affection, and the like that flow when relationships are recognised); and expression values (right-use of body, mind, and wealth in assembly).

Impression names the describable event in which one unit’s activity registers on another in mutuality — alongside complementarity and mutual recognition.

Every unit recognises its relationships and fulfils them:

> **“Every entity of nature recognises another; that is why it fulfils. An atomic particle too recognises another, and as a result, these particles abide in orderliness.”**
> *- JV, p. 69*

That recognition and fulfilment draw on capacity, ability, and receptivity — endowed through saturation and developed or activated through environment and interference (SB, p. 61). At the material, biological, and animal orders, fulfilment is definite — structural, seed, or species conformance. In the knowledge order the same relationships must be achieved through knowing → believing → recognising → fulfilling; where evaluation mis-reads relationships, complementarity remains incompletely expressed. At every order, fulfilment evidences use, right-use, and purposeful-use (MVD, p. 27).

Higher statuses require inherent capacity and a conducive environment together. SB illustrates the bond with seed and naturalness — illustrative, not identity: germination begins when a seed is placed in its naturalness; without naturalness, exuberance cannot happen in it (SB, p. 54). Saturation endows inherent capacity; naturalness and mutuality in environment activate it — neither alone suffices.

The completeness drive turns unit-activity toward fulfilling relationships, step by step, at higher levels. Units move toward satisfaction by recognising and fulfilling relationships built into coexistence — not by maximising an abstract quantity. When those relationships are fully evident across nature, the texts call that realisation in coexistence (SB, p. 51): not a new state of the ground, but fulfilment made clear within coexistence.

1.5 The four orders of nature

Units of nature are organised into four stable orders — material (*padarth*), pranic/bio (*pran*), animal (*jeev*), and knowledge/human (*gyan*). Each order is a stable plateau in development, not a human typology. Higher orders include the *dharma*s of lower orders cumulatively (SB, p. 179; MVD, p. 115).

Order	Essential nature (*svabhav*)	***Dharma*** **(cumulative)**
Material (*padarth*)	integration–disintegration (*sangathan–vighatan*)	existence (*astitva*)
Bio (*pran*)	vitalising–devitalising (*sarak–marak*)	+ growth (*pushti*)
Animal (*jeev*)	cruel–uncruel	+ hope to live (*jeene ki aasha*)
Knowledge / human (*gyan*)	fortitude, courage, generosity, kindness, grace, compassion	+ happiness (*sukh*)

The cumulative *dharma*s mark where sentience enters. The material and bio/pranic orders are insentient (*jada*): they integrate, disintegrate, vitalise, and grow, but have no hope to live. Hope to live (*jeene ki aasha*) is the animal order's addition — and hope is the defining activity of the sentient unit, expressed through *mun* in the constitutionally complete atom. *Jeevan* first appears at the animal order; the material and pranic orders are pre-sentient development toward it. The knowledge order's six *svabhav* qualities are developed as human values (JV, p. 44).

Existence is stable and development is definite — laws natural and inherent to being, not conventions imposed on unstable matter (MVD, p. 5). That definiteness names two paired structures at the order scale. Existential progression (*niyati-kram*) is the fixed sequence in which order-level nature manifests on Earth: pranic from material, animal from pranic, knowledge from animal — chemical composition giving rise to biological cells, vegetation enriching, animal and human bodies and traditions established through that chain (MVD, pp. 8, 13; *Paribhasha Samhita*, ed. 2008). SB qualifies without dissolving the chain: the biological order can revert to the material after manifesting its essentiality, while elevation from material into biological order is not irreversible development in the same sense as constitutional completeness at the atomic level (SB, pp. 76–78). The way of existence (*niyati-vidhi*) is definiteness in each order's proper conduct — result-, seed-, species-, and *sanskar*-conformance. In the animal order that species-conformance carries through *adhyasa* — a species-traditional inertial impression transmitted from gestation, the inheritance of conduct-pattern

(SB, pp. 62–63); this is a homonym of, and must not be confused with, Advaita's *adhyasa* as superimposition (§5.7.5). SB names statuses embedded in this progression: diversity in nature is diversity of statuses within matter, with constitutional, activity, and conduct completeness as further designed stages toward which units are meant for completeness (SB, pp. 50–52, 78).

Each order cyclically manifests through saturation in a different mode (MVD, p. 289): material units are active because of being in Omnipresence; bio units pulsate; animal units carry the hope of living; knowledge-order units are hopeful and conscientious. *Countless* means practical uncountability — real particulars, indefinitely many from any finite standpoint (SB, p. 49).

1.6 The completeness drive and transitions (T1, T2, T3)

The three endowments of saturation — recognition capability, activeness, and inherent regulation — ground a unit's completeness drive. Rather than an ethic added to matter, this drive is built into the basic design of existence. It runs through two atomic paths powered by the *shram–gati–parinam* (effort–motion–result) triad.

In the evolving insentient atom (*jada parmanu*), the triad drives hungry and overfull exchange toward constitutional completeness (*gathanpurnata* / T1). In the constitutionally complete *jeevan* atom, the triad works through projection and reflection (SB, p. 60) toward activity completeness (*kriyapurnata* / T2) and conduct completeness (*vyavaharpurnata* / T3).

All change is unit-activity. Omnipresence is *sthitipurn*: the ground does not change. A unit is not a passive substrate that merely possesses activity; its existence is this triadic activity.

> **"Every physical-chemical activity is an inseparable presence of effort, motion and result. Each of these is a joint form of the other two."**
> *- SB, p. 58*

Effort, motion, and result are not three sequential steps but three joint aspects of one activity — in sodium and chlorine ions approaching one another, the approach is effort and motion together and the stable salt crystal is result (SB, p. 58).

That unfolding is internal to saturation, not an external push — SB compresses the chain:

> **"Saturation in uniform energy itself is forcefulness, forcefulness itself is basic impulsion, basic impulsion itself is activity, activity itself is effort-motion-result, effort-motion-result itself is development and its continuity."**
> *- SB, p. 62*

Each link is internal unfolding grounded in saturation, not a mechanical reaction chain. In insentient orders, state and motion are inseparable — force in state, power in motion (SB, pp.

248–249).

Each triad term has a teleological goal. The insentient path completes the first; the sentient path continues with the other two (SB, pp. 58, 71):

> **“In the sentient atom:**
> **- Conduct completeness is in the form of destination of motion.**
> **- Activity completeness is in the form of restfulness of effort.**
> **- Constitutional completeness (the jeevan atom) is in the form of immortality of result.”**
> *- SB, p. 58*
>
> **“The result is meant to attain the goal of immortality, the effort is meant to attain the goal of restfulness, motion is meant to attain the goal of destination. This goal itself becomes evident in the form of development progression and development.”**
> *- SB, p. 71*
>
> **”…at the core of effort, motion and result, the study of immortality of result, restfulness of effort, and final-destination of motion is necessary…”**
> *- MVD, p. 104*

At the knowledge order the same joint structure appears in conduct humans recognise directly. Learning to build a useful tool joins internal effort (*shram*) — studying the design and visualising the form — with outward motion (*gati*) — shaping, assembling, and putting the tool to work — and yields a stable result (*parinam*) in the finished implement. In sentient nature that single activity orients toward restfulness of effort when understanding settles, toward destination of motion when the work serves right-use and universal orderliness, and toward immortality of result when the accomplishment stands as a durable contribution rather than a passing exertion.

The three completeness transitions mark developmental milestones on these paths:

Transition	Completeness	Plane shift	Triad term	Teleological goal	What becomes evident
T1	Constitutional (*gathanpurnata*)	Physicochemical → delusional	Result	Immortality of result (*parinam ki amarta*)	Sentient *jeevan*; hope to live

Transition	Completeness	Plane shift	Triad term	Teleological goal	What becomes evident
T2	Activity (*kriyapurnata*)	Delusional → deific	Effort	Restfulness of effort (*shram ka vishram*)	Awakened humans; orderliness with *ness*
T3	Conduct (*vyavaharpurnata*)	Deific → divine (complete)	Motion	Destination of motion (*gati ka gantavya*)	Awakened humans with evidence (*pramanikta*)

These goals must not be conflated with natural-state ease in §1.3. *Vishram* names the settlement of internal cognitive effort (*shram*) — *jeevan*'s seeking, visualising, and analysing resolving into direct realisation — not insentient complementarity reinstating *svabhav gati*. *Gantavya* names the settlement of external behavioural motion (*gati*) in work and social participation toward universal orderliness.

1.6.1 Constitutional completeness (T1)

T1 is the irreversible sentience threshold: constitutional completeness (*gathanpurnata*) at the atomic level — not neural complexity, molecular size, or mere elevation along the order chain (SB, p. 52). Molecules exhibit characteristics of development but not actual development; the sentient threshold is constitutional completeness of the atom (SB, p. 52). T1 is irreversible at the atomic level (SB, p. 92).

An insentient atom (*parmanu*) — a composite of nucleus and orbiting particles (MVD, p. 42) — reaches *gathanpurnata* through particle incorporation, hungry and overfull complementarity, and environmental mutuality — inherent capacity from saturation plus a mutuality of environment in which the required particles can integrate (MVD, p. 8; SB, pp. 58, 71). When the required particles are integrated, the atom becomes constitutionally complete: satisfaction within, by, and for that constitution — the goal of result, immortality of result (*parinam ki amarta*), and sentient status (SB, p. 59).

In this state there is neither increase nor decrease in particle count; the atom undergoes qualitative change without quantitative change (SB, p. 55).

Before constitutional completeness, an evolving-constitution atom carries molecular-bondage and weight-bondage. On crossing T1 it is liberated from both; hope-bondage replaces them as the sentient mode's defining bondage (MVD, p. 91; MVD, p. 117; SB, p. 114):

> **“An evolving-constitution atom is with molecular-bondage and weight-bondage. However, when the contraction and expansion activity increases in this atom, it instantly breaks free from its group and attains constitutional completeness, becoming a jeevan atom. The evidence of constitutional completeness is the jeevan atom’s liberation from molecular-bondage and weight-bondage, and its having the hope-bondage.”**
> *- MVD, p. 91*

All saturated units participate in inherent orderliness. Insentient units exhibit radiance and projection (SB, p. 69). At *gathanpurnata*, a constitutionally complete atom acts as a mediating reflector configuration: the stable compound reflects what is ever-present in *satta* as active sentience (*chaitanya*). What was latent in the ground — permeative *gyan* as the intelligibility of coexistence — is actualised when the atom’s particle constitution closes. Sentience is latency actualised within coexistence.

1.6.2 Activity completeness (T2)

T2 is the settlement of internal cognitive effort — restfulness of effort (*shram ka vishram*): *jeevan*‘s seeking, visualising, and analysing resolving into direct realisation (*anubhav*) in coexistence, culminating in absolute resolution (*samadhan*) (SB, p. 61; MVD, p. 65). T2 is not the relational ease of insentient natural-state fulfilment in §1.3 — that reinstates *svabhav gati*, not *shram ka vishram*.

1.6.3 Conduct completeness (T3)

T3 is where external behavioural motion reaches its destination — destination of motion (*gati ka gantavya*): authentic conduct and living proof (*pramanikta*) in universal orderliness (*vyavastha*), yielding mutual satisfaction and justice (MVD, p. 80). T3 is not a second name for the same internal settlement as T2.

At the knowledge order, perceiver status (*drishta pad*) — enlightenment and realisation within the truth of coexistence — is what awakened humans attain. Activity completeness (T2) and conduct completeness (T3) evidence it in orderliness with *ness* and living proof (SB, pp. 137–138, 159).

1.6.4 Time and causation

The texts distinguish origination (units co-eternally present) from causation (what produces change when units transform). Omnipresence grounds all units through saturation as supreme cause (*mahakaran*) in the sustaining sense — the ground of activity, not its trigger (MVD, pp. 288–289; SB, pp. 49, 62). The causal work of change is done by units themselves.

Time (*kaal*) is the duration of unit-activity — inseparable from effort, motion, and result in active units, not a separate cosmic container alongside *satta* and units. Omnipresence is timeless as non-transforming ground. Full treatment: *Nature of Time*.

1.7 *Jeevan*: structure and faculties

Jeevan — the sentient self that works through the body (*shareer*) — is a constitutionally complete unit: a self-maintaining sentient atom whose particle constitution has closed at T1, not a conventional aggregate of insentient parts.

MVD lists five inseparable aspects — *mun*, *vritti*, *chitta*, *buddhi*, and *atma* — within the *jeevan*-cloud (MVD, p. 13). They operate through the projection and reflection cycle (*paravartan* and *pratyavartan*):

Strength / power	Projection (*paravartan*)	Reflection (*pratyavartan*)
Mun / hope	selection	taste (*asvad*)
Vritti / thought	analysis	deliberation
Chitta / desire	visualisation	contemplation
Buddhi	resolve (*sankalp*)	enlightenment (*bodh*)
Atma	authenticity (*pramanikta*)	realisation (*anubhav*)

The five faculties are the atom's constitutional structure: *atma* is the nucleus; *buddhi*, *chitta*, *vritti*, and *mun* are the particles in the first through fourth orbits respectively (MVD, p. 78). JV presents the same structure as ten coordinated activities across nucleus and orbits — taste and selection in *mun*, deliberation and analysis in *vritti*, contemplation and visualisation in *chitta*, enlightenment and resolve in *buddhi*, and realisation and authenticity in *atma* (JV, p. 92).

> **"The nucleus of the sentient unit (a constitutionally complete atom) is referred to as atma. The particles in its first orbit are referred to as buddhi, those in the second orbit are referred to as chitta, those in the third orbit are referred to as vritti, and those in the fourth orbit are referred to as mun."**
> *- MVD, p. 78*

These five faculties are one of two five-fold structures in the texts and must not be conflated with the second — they do not align one-to-one. The five faculties (*mun* through *atma*) name the invariant parts and orbital structure of the *jeevan* atom itself: what a constitutionally complete sentient unit is at the atomic level.

Alongside them, Madhyasth Darshan maps the developmental envelopes of the joint form (body + *jeevan*) in *kosha* (sheath) vocabulary — *annamaya*, *pranamaya* (*pran kosha* in the texts' shorthand), *manomaya*, *anandamaya*, and *vigyanmaya* (MVD, pp. 49–50). Animal-order *jeevan* and pre-awakening (deluded) humans function across four koshas; awakening adds a fifth, *vigyanmaya* — the sheath of right knowledge — so awakened humans function across five. Faculties track what *jeevan* is structurally; koshas track where awakening has opened — a given faculty is not the same thing as a given sheath, and the two lists cannot be read as parallel columns.

On the delusional plane, *atma* is the "I" at the nucleus; the inseparable orbital set *buddhi–chitta–vritti–mun* is "mine"; awakening is these four coming into accordance with *atma* (MVD, p. 78). Mistaking the body for the self is the root of that confusion (SB, pp. 91–92).

1.8 *Jeevan* harmonies and experience

Awakening is not only a plane label or completeness stage. It is also felt harmony within the faculty structure of §1.7 — happiness, peace, contentment, and bliss as orbital faculties come into accordance with *atma*.

JV names four *jeevan* values — happiness, peace, contentment, and bliss — as harmonies between faculty pairs:

> **"Among the values, jeevan values are known by the names — happiness, peace, contentment and bliss, which are only names of the state of harmony within jeevan. Happiness is when there is harmony in mun and vritti, peace is when there is harmony in vritti and chitta, contentment is when there is harmony in chitta and buddhi, and bliss is when there is harmony in buddhi and atma."**
> *- JV, p. 138*

MVD states the same progression as effects of *atma* realised in truth on the lower faculties — taste (*asvad*) in *mun* registers as happiness; enthusiasm or peace in *vritti*; rejoicing or contentment in *chitta*; immersion or bliss in *buddhi* (MVD, p. 101).

> **"The mode of channelling jeevan's energies towards development (awakening) is through curiosity in mun, enthusiasm in vritti, delight in chitta, elation and immersion in buddhi, and finally, realisation in atma. For this, inward regulation of jeevan energies is essential."**
> *- MVD, p. 77*

Inward regulation is self-regulation within the sentient unit — mediative *atma* at the nucleus disciplines the orbital faculties and body (MVD, p. 277). The mediative nucleus at the atomic level and *atma* at the sentient centre are the same structural role at two scales (MVD, pp. 26, 78) — not mere analogy.

Jeevan does not sleep when the body sleeps; values and evaluation are *jeevan*'s practical purpose. Activity completeness (T2) and conduct completeness (T3) evidence perceiver status (*drishta pad*) in orderliness with *ness* and living proof.

> **“Jeevan continues to exist even after death as it does while driving a body.”**
> *- JV, p. 20*

Because *jeevan* is a constitutionally complete atom, it persists indefinitely across bodily birth and death, carrying its accumulated impressions and state of awakening.

1.9 Progressions and planes

Madhyasth Darshan maps change and development across two coordinates: progressions (how nature moves) and planes (where a unit stands).

1.9.1 Four progressions

The texts use four different words for “progress” at different levels; they must not be collapsed:

1. Existential progression (*niyati-kram*) — fixed order emergence: material → pranic → animal → knowledge.
2. Way of existence (*niyati-vidhi*) — definiteness in each order’s conduct.
3. Development progression (*vikas-kram*) — through the physicochemical complex until an atom reaches constitutional completeness and sentient *jeevan* appears (MVD, pp. 13–14).
4. Awakening progression (*jagriti-kram*) — within constitutionally complete *jeevan*, toward fuller activity and conduct (MVD, pp. 13–14).

Macro order chain (*niyati-kram*) and atomic development (*vikas-kram*) run on different levels — the fixed sequence in which bodies and orders appear on Earth is not the same process as an atom closing its particle constitution at the sentience threshold.

MVD distinguishes development progression and awakening progression as actualities of coexistence alongside order-level enrichment (MVD, pp. 13–14). Molecules and larger assemblies participate in composition and in *vikas-kram* at the atomic scale; crossing T1 is not the same as the order-to-order chain named in *niyati-kram*.

The two axes meet at the pranic→animal junction. *Niyati-kram* delivers, on Earth, the bodily basis of the animal order from enriched pranic life (MVD, pp. 8, 13; SB, pp. 76–77); *vikas-kram* delivers, at the atomic scale, an atom that has reached constitutional completeness (MVD, p. 91). An animal is the joint presence of such a *jeevan* atom with a body of that order — the body comes from the order chain; the sentient unit comes from atomic constitutional completeness.

In the sentient mode, effort–motion–result maps to the three teleological goals named in §1.6: result toward immortality of result at T1; effort toward restfulness of effort at T2; motion toward destination of motion at T3 (SB, pp. 58, 71). Sentient nature also works through projection and reflection toward relational closure (*samadhan*) at the knowledge order (SB, pp. 60, 64–65, 69).

1.9.2 Four planes

Order names what a unit is; plane (*pad*) names how far its development has gone — where on the map it currently stands, not merely what kind of unit it is (SB, p. 52). SB lists four planes:

Plane	Plain meaning
Physicochemical	Insentient development toward constitutional completeness
Delusional	Sentient *jeevan* or pre-awakening human — body mistaken for self
Deific	Awakening human — activity completeness (T2)
Divine (complete)	Conduct completeness (T3) — living proof of coexistence

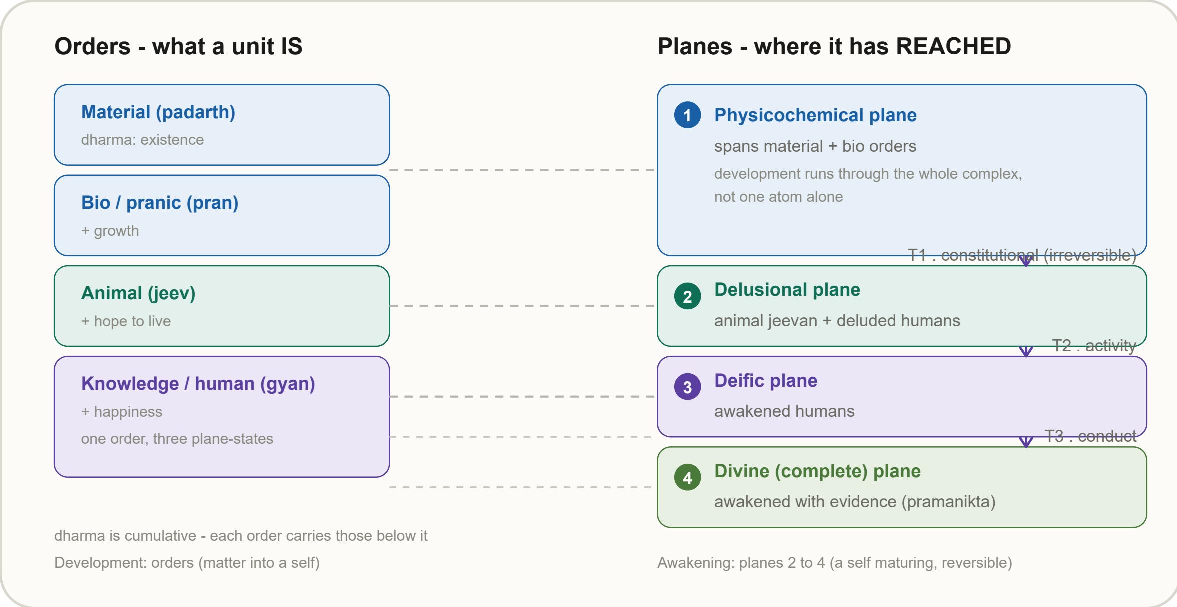
"Delusional" here names a developmental stage in the texts, not psychiatric illness.

Orders and planes are different axes, and they do not line up one-to-one (SB, p. 52):

Order	Plane(s) it occupies	Status
Material (*padarth*)	Physicochemical	Insentient (*jada*)
Bio / pranic (*pran*)	Physicochemical	Insentient (*jada*)
Animal (*jeev*)	Delusional	Sentient *jeevan*; body-identified
Knowledge / human (*gyan*)	Delusional → deific → divine	Sentient *jeevan*; awakening across planes

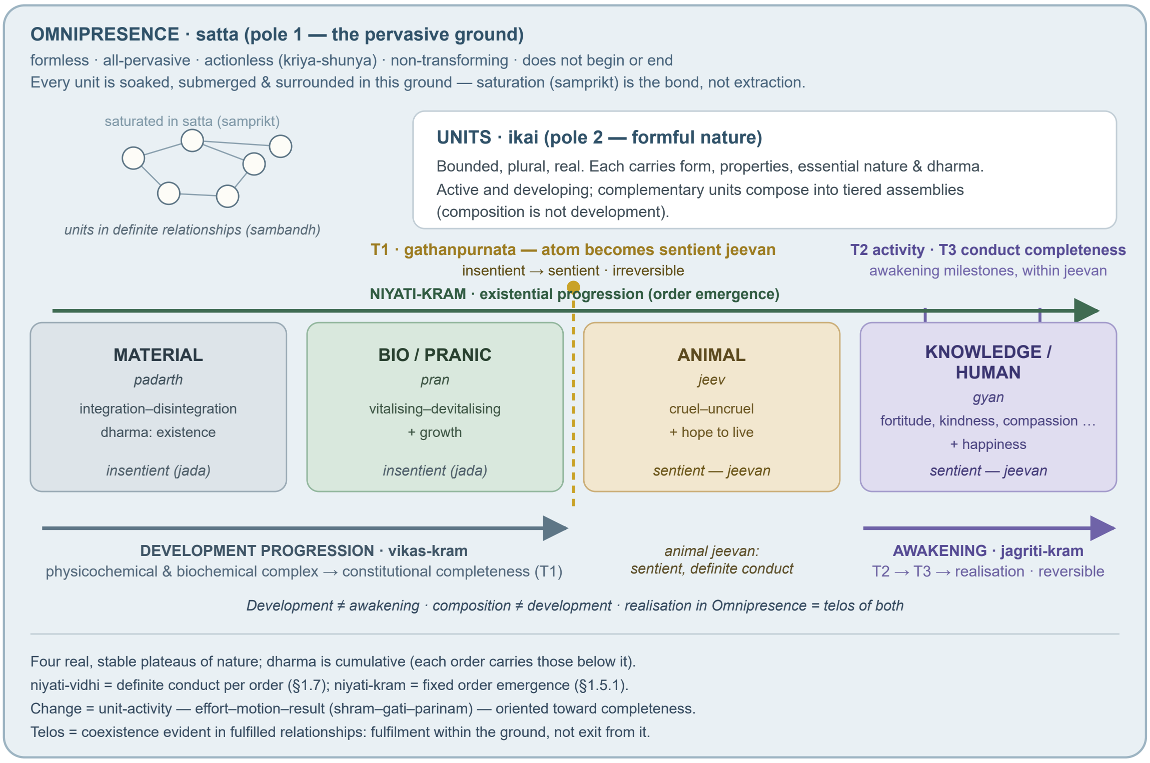
Two orders thus map to one plane (physicochemical), while one order maps to three — the asymmetry the figure below renders, and the reason order and plane must not be used interchangeably.

Within these planes the texts distinguish five human types by degree of awakening — the servile human (*pashu-manav*) and the brutal human (*rakshas-manav*) on the delusional plane, the discerning human in transition, the *dev-manav* on the deific plane, and the fully awakened *divya-manav* on the divine plane (MVD, p. 160). Awakening to the knowledge order requires the human body as enabling medium — with fully enriched nervous system and imagination — not merely a vehicle any sentient plane could use (MVD, p. 115; JV, pp. 79, 93).



Madhyasth Darshan — the architecture of coexistence

Beginningless coexistence: two co-eternal poles, neither made from the other — the world fully real.

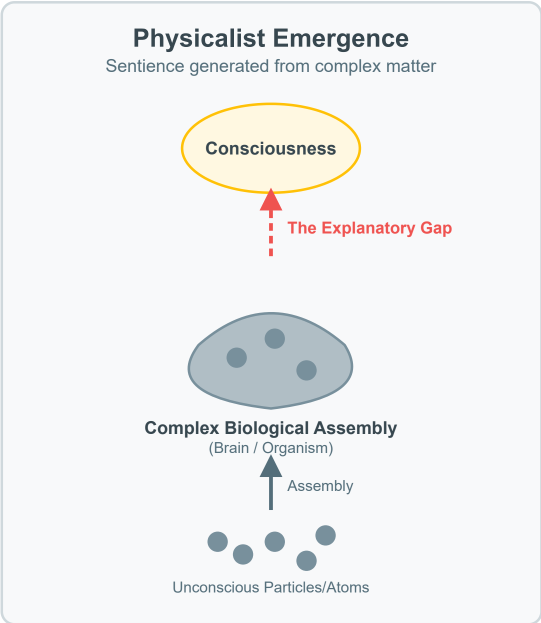


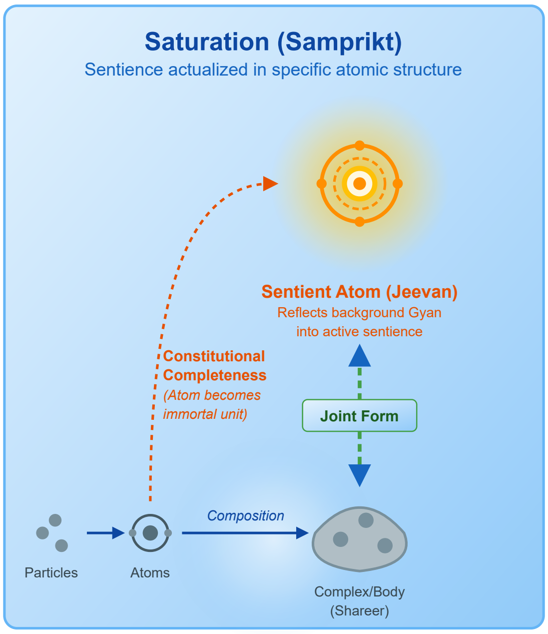
Beginningless & conserved

Nothing arises from, or vanishes into, non-being (abhava).
Bodies, configurations & associations begin and end;
underlying vastu persists through transformation.
"Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual" (jagat satat).

Causation & time

Satta is mahakaran — the sustaining ground, not the efficient cause; units do the work of change.
Time (kaal) = duration of unit-activity, not an independent cosmic container.





1.10 Composition and assemblies

When complementary units fulfil their relationships, they compose into larger units:

> **"Everywhere, there exists a natural inclination towards coexistence. This inclination is what leads atomic particles to assemble into atoms, atoms to combine into molecules, and molecules to combine into molecular forms."**
> *- JV, p. 67*

Each successful composition opens relationships at a higher tier — particles to atoms, atoms to molecules, molecules to cells and bodies, and onward to human assemblies — while stability persists in natural state and declines when fulfilment breaks down (SB, p. 14). On the insentient atomic path, collections and assemblies participate in *vikas-kram* toward T1; the completeness drive also scales complementarity upward through *niyati-kram* at the order level.

In a mixture (*mishran*), components maintain their respective conducts. In a compound (*yaugik*), components combine in definite proportion and present a genuinely new unit with its own four-aspect signature (MVD, p. 42).

Composition is not development. The developmental plateau is crossed only when an atom reaches constitutional completeness. Assemblies persist while relationships are fulfilled in their natural state and decline when they are not (SB, p. 14). Transmission of composition method (*rachna vidhi*) runs by constitution, seed, lineage, or education-*sanskar* according to order (JV, pp. 48, 82; MVD, pp. 92–93).

When assemblies are human compositions — family, community, and society — the same persist-or-decline rule applies, but recognition and fulfilment are achieved and evaluative rather than definite. Human assemblies, like molecules and bodies, are real compositions whose durability tracks relationship-fulfilment, not fear or extraction alone.

1.11 Regulation, law, and conformance

Inherent regulation is the third endowment of saturation. Saturated units are self-regulating (*swatah-saspurt*); orderliness is inherent to nature rather than dispensed by an external ruler. This mediative (*madhyasth*) regulation regulates and conserves every unit. *Satta* does not descend as statutory command.

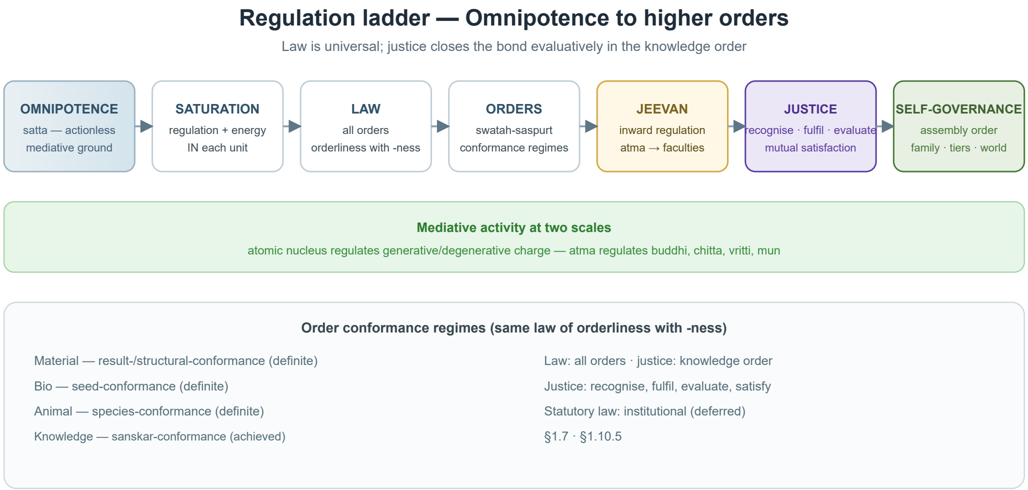
> **"Regulation itself becomes clear in the form of law. Consequently, there is provision in every unit for recognising one another based on law. This itself is the meaning of regulation."**
> *- SB, p. 57*
>
> **"Omnipotence is mediative, therefore the nature saturated in it is regulated and conserved. The nucleus within every atom is the mediative activity, whereby the atom's generative-degenerative activities and relative powers are regulated and conserved."**
> *- MVD, p. 26*

Orderliness (*vyavastha*) at the level of co-existing orders is self-regulation — inherent in nature's orders, not dispensed by a cosmic governor — the mediative role that gives the darshan its name. The same inherent orderliness in each unit, by which it participates in overall orderliness, is the law that — recognised and fulfilled at the knowledge order — scales into the universal orderliness of an undivided society.

Regulation manifests as law (*niyam*), which is expressed through order-specific conformance modes (*niyati-vidhi*):

Order	Conformance mode	Definite or achieved
Material (*padarth*)	Result- / structural-conformance	Definite
Bio (*pran*)	Seed-conformance	Definite
Animal (*jeev*)	Species-conformance	Definite
Knowledge / human (*gyan*)	*Sanskar*-conformance	Achieved through knowing → believing → recognising → fulfilling

In the animal order, species-conformance is transmitted through *adhyasa* (gestational inheritance of conduct patterns; not to be confused with Advaita's *adhyasa*).



Below the knowledge order, lawful recognition and fulfilment need no separate name for evaluation. Once *jeevan* must evaluate and can err, the texts name the evaluative closure of the relational cycle justice (*nyaya*). Statutory and public law (*dharma-niti*, *rajya-niti*) codifies assembly order separately; conduct may satisfy legality while violating justice. Institutional governance belongs in the planned *Governance Justice and Undivided Society* study.

Domain	Scope	Ontological status
Regulation / law	All four orders	Inherent in saturated units; same law of orderliness with *ness*
Justice (*nyaya*)	Knowledge order	Complete relational activity: recognise, fulfil, evaluate, mutual satisfaction
Statutory / public law	Assemblies, society	Institutional codification; may diverge from justice

1.12 Evaluative perspectives and justice

Only *jeevan* in the knowledge order evaluates and chooses (JV, p. 70). It does not use a single lens. *Jeevan*'s design includes six perspectives (*drishti*) for knowing, believing, evaluation, and choice. In awakening, humane refuge reorganises under *nyaya*, *dharma*, and *satya* rather than *priya*, *hita*, and *labh* (MVD, pp. 27, 67).

> **"All human behaviour is manifest in six perspectives: - (1) pleasant-unpleasant, (2) healthy-unhealthy, (3) profit-loss, (4) justice-injustice, (5) dharma-adharma, and (6) truth-untruth."**
> *- MVD, p. 67*
>
> **"The behaviour of humans with inhumane perspective is in the refuge of pleasant-unpleasant, healthy-unhealthy, and profit-loss. The behaviour of humans with humane perspective is in the refuge of justice-injustice, dharma-adharma, and truth-untruth."**
> *- MVD, p. 67*

Perspective	Domain	Role in evaluation
Priya–apriya (pleasant-unpleasant)	Senses / instincts	Lower refuge; insufficient as main standpoint
Hita–ahita (healthy-unhealthy)	Body	Lower refuge; insufficient as main standpoint
Labh–alabh (profit-loss)	Material comfort	Lower refuge; insufficient as main standpoint
Nyaya–anyaya (justice-injustice)	Behaviour (*vyavahar*)	Humane refuge; regulates conduct
Dharma–adharma (dharma-adharma)	Resolution (*samadhan*)	Humane refuge; disciplines thought
Satya–asatya (truth-untruth)	Existence	Humane refuge; grounds realisation in reality

The lower triad is legitimate in its domain — food and instinct, bodily health, livelihood — but not sufficient as the organising refuge of a knowledge-order being. Awakening subordinates rather than abandons those domains: pleasant, healthy, and profitable outcomes stay meaningful when ordered under justice, dharma, and truth (Ethics and Morals in Human Beings §3.2).

Unit *dharma* (§1.3) — the fourth aspect of every unit's signature — must not be confused with the *dharma–adharma* perspective: the latter is an evaluative *drishti* on thought and resolution, not the innateness and fulfilment of a unit as such.

These perspectives regulate distinct domains:

> **"The regulation of human behaviour takes place through justice, discipline in thoughts takes place through dharma, and realisation takes place only through truth."**
> *- MVD, p. 137*

1.12.1 The dual role of justice

Justice (*nyaya*) has a dual role. As a perspective, it assesses behaviour as just or unjust. As an ontological term, justice names the full relational activity when the cycle closes: relationships recognised, values fulfilled, evaluation done, mutual satisfaction reached. Justice is not trust, respect, or a moral value among values.

> **"Recognising relationships, fulfilling values, evaluating, and achieving mutual satisfaction is justice."**
> *- MVD, p. 311*

Dharma as evaluative perspective disciplines thought toward resolution (*samadhan*). *Satya* grounds assessment in realisation in existence rather than in liking, bodily expedience, or gain. Below the knowledge order, recognition and fulfilment are lawful and definite without bearing the name justice, because evaluation and the possibility of error are not yet in play.

1.13 Knowledge in coexistence

The texts use *gyan* and related words at four distinct senses. Treating them as one thing is the main source of misreading — for example, treating Omnipresence as a conscious mind, or fulfilled relationships as private belief.

Sense	What it names	Primary locus	Epistemic role
Realisation Knowledge (*anubhav jnan*)	Orderliness already present in saturated units	All units in Omnipresence (MVD, p. 11)	Ontological given — what exists to be known
Gyan as *satta*	Intelligibility-ground; Space as knowledge	Omnipresence (MVD, p. 35)	Condition of intelligibility — not a knowing subject
Realisation in coexistence	Relationships fulfilled and evident	Knowledge-order telos (MVD, p. 116; SB, p. 51)	Goal of complete knowing — not a new state of the ground
Gyan udghatan	Unfolding of knowledge in thought and conduct	Awakened *jeevan* only (MVD, pp. 115–116, 289)	Activity of the knower — exclusive to awakened humans

Realisation Knowledge is the ontological given already stated in coexistence and unit structure — saturated units with form, properties, essential nature, *dharma*, and orderliness:

> **"All units saturated in the Omnipresence (permeative and transparent) have form, properties, essential nature & dharma, and have inherent orderliness & participate in overall orderliness."**
> *- MVD, p. 11*

This is knowledge as what is in every unit — not yet the human accomplishment of understanding. *Gyan* as *satta* names the ground's state-complete intelligibility: relational, evaluatively structured orderliness — not merely statistical regularity, and not a mind that knows (Editorial Notes). What was latent in that ground is actualised as active sentience at constitutional completeness; Omnipresence does not unfold knowledge as a knower.

Realisation in coexistence is the telos the completeness drive names — relationships fulfilled and made evident across nature, not a transformation of *satta* itself. *Gyan udghatan* — the unfolding of knowledge — is the activity by which awakened *jeevan* brings what is given into lived understanding; it occurs only through the sentient aspect or thoughts, not through insentient units and not through Omnipresence acting as a knower (MVD, pp. 115–116, 289).

Orderliness in all saturated units, active sentience at *gathanpurnata*, and knowledge unfolding through awakened humans are three different senses. Conflating them produces either pan-knowing Omnipresence or a world with no inherent intelligibility to unfold.

Knowledge is inherent everywhere in coexistence — Realisation Knowledge in every unit, intelligibility in *satta* — but its unfolding happens through awakened humans (MVD, p. 115). At the knowledge order the same relationships that are definite below must be achieved through knowing → believing → recognising → fulfilling. In a deluded human, believing is separated from knowing — believing without knowing. In an awakened human the two are unified: one knows existence as coexistence, believes this truth, and spontaneously recognises and fulfils relationships.

This unfolding occurs through the human as a joint form of *jeevan* and body. The brain acts as a physical interface for cognitive expression, but the knower is always the sentient *jeevan*, not the physical body.

Complete knowledge (*paripoorna gyan*) encompasses knowledge of the self (*jeevan*), knowledge of existence as coexistence (*saha-astitva*), and knowledge of humane conduct (*manaviyata purna acharan*). Its ultimate test is lived evidence (*pramanikta*) in behaviour and experiment, not private intellectual assent.

1.14 Conservation and the perpetual world

Madhyasth Darshan advances two distinct conservation claims.

Coexistence conservation: what exists does not arise from non-being (*abhava*) and cannot be annihilated. Plurality is perpetual; only configurations and associations change. The world is perpetual (*jagat satat*).

Jeevan persistence: because *jeevan* is constitutionally complete and immune to decomposition, it persists across bodily birth and death.

Coexistence is co-eternal: *satta* remains state-complete, while units remain state-dynamic, moving toward designed completeness within their saturated bond.

> **"Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual."**
> *- MVD, p. 13*

1.15 Ontology and societal fulfilment outcomes

At the human scale, the completeness drive manifests as societal outcomes. When the cognitive and behavioural cycle of justice completes, it evidences four human goals: resolution (*samadhan*) — intellectual clarity and relational closure without residue; prosperity (*samridhi*) — producing more physical goods than needed and utilising them properly, rather than hoarding; fearlessness (*abhay*) — trust in the present and in society, rather than collectivity based on mutual threat; and coexistence (*saha-astitva*) — complementary living with other humans and nature.

These goals align directly with internal *jeevan* values:

> **"Resolution = Happiness. We realise happiness wherever we are resolved... Thereafter, we realise peace while evidencing resolution and prosperity in the family. We realise contentment by living orderly in society. We realise bliss in the course of evidencing our understanding."**
> *- JV, p. 61*

Unlike animals, whose collectivity arises primarily from fear, human sociality is built on resolution and trust.

At the macro scale, these goals compose upward from the family to undivided society (*akhand samaj*) and universal orderliness (*sarvabhaum vyavastha*). This is the expression of human *dharma* — the telos of the knowledge order.

Universal orderliness is actualised across five dimensions: education-character (*shiksha-sanskar*), justice-preservation (*nyaya-suraksha*), health-restraint (*swasthya-sanyam*), production-work (*utpadan-karya*), and exchange-storage (*vinimay-kosh*).

1.16 Method, evidence, and what Madhyasth Darshan establishes

Madhyasth Darshan answers the study's framing questions as follows:

Question	Madhyasth Darshan answer	Section
What is existence?	The eternal coexistence of *satta* and units	§1.1

Question	Madhyasth Darshan answer	Section
What exists?	Omnipresence (*satta*) and countable units (*ikai*)	§§1.1, 1.5
Does it begin?	No; only temporary configurations do	§1.14
Does the self begin?	*Jeevan* is constitutionally immortal and does not end with the body	§§1.6, 1.7, 1.8
Is the world real?	Yes, the world is perpetual (*jagat satat*)	§1.14
How do we know?	Through staged study, experiment, and conduct-evidence	§1.13

The darshan establishes a logical ontology of coexistence, saturation, and conservation. Lived verification through humane conduct (*pramanikta*) serves as the final proof of realisation.

2. The Advaita Vedanta Answer

Advaita Vedanta holds that existence in the strictest, absolute sense is Brahman alone — one without a second (*ekamevaditiyam*). The world of names, forms, bodies, and relations is *mithya* — a dependent appearance operationally valid at the empirical level (*vyavahara*) but ultimately sublated at absolute reality (*paramartha*). The true Self (*Atman*) is neither born nor destroyed, because it is ultimately identical with this non-dual Brahman.

The exposition moves from Brahman as absolute existence and Sat-Chit-Ananda through the three tiers of reality (*pratibhasika*, *vyavahara*, *paramartha*). Maya, *adhyasa*, and causal doctrine (*satkaryavada*, *vivartavada*) explain how multiplicity appears on changeless Brahman; Ishvara, *jiva*, and *jagat* structure the shared empirical world. Witness-consciousness (*sakshin*, *turiya*) names the seer discriminated from body and mind. Conservation, origination, and temporality divide timeless Brahman from law-governed *vyavahara*; liberation (*moksha*) and the knowledge path describe how separateness is dispelled. Ethics, *loka-sangraha*, and what realisation evidences at the empirical order close the section. The figure at §2.5 summarises the architecture; Advaita terms appear in the Appendix under Terms in §2.

2.1 Brahman and absolute existence

> **"In the beginning this was Existence alone, One only, without a second."**
> *- CU 6.2.1*

Shankara glosses *sat* as:

> **“mere Existence, a thing that is subtle, without distinction, all pervasive, one, taintless, partless, consciousness”**
> *- CU 6.2.1, Shankara commentary*

Advaita’s opening move parallels Madhyasth Darshan’s refusal of origination from non-being, but compresses the answer differently. The text rejects existence arising from non-existence:

> **“By what logic can existence verily come out of non-existence? But surely, o good looking one, in the beginning all this was Existence, One only, without a second.”**
> *- CU 6.2.2*

At *paramartha*, only this one partless reality exists absolutely. *Paramatman* is not a second absolute beside Brahman — it is Brahman named from the empirical or devotional standpoint, sublated together with Ishvara and jiva when superimposition is perfectly eliminated (VC, v. 244; §2.5).

2.2 Sat-Chit-Ananda and the three states

A second classical formulation names existence not only as *sat* — bare being — but as Sat-Chit-Ananda: being-consciousness-bliss. These are not three realities added together; Brahman is one partless reality whose nature is expressed in three inseparable names.

> **“Brahman is Truth, Knowledge, and Infinity.”**
> *- TU 2.1.1*

Shankara’s tradition reads *satyam* as being/reality, *jnanam* as consciousness, and *anantam* as the infinite. The *anandamaya* passage (TU 2.5) leads the seeker beyond even bliss-as-sheath to the Self beyond all coverings. Shankara states the mature formula in the *Vivekachudamani*:

> **“By that alone he comes to know his own Self as Existence-Knowledge-Bliss Absolute and becomes happy.”**
> *- VC, v. 152*

The same triad recurs at v. 217, one of the most comprehensive Self-descriptions in the *Vivekachudamani*:

> **"That which clearly manifests Itself in the states of wakefulness, dream and profound sleep; which is inwardly perceived in the mind in various forms as an unbroken series of egoistic impressions; which witnesses the egoism, the Buddhi, etc., which are of diverse forms and modifications; and which makes Itself felt as the Existence-Knowledge-Bliss Absolute; know thou this Atman, thy own Self, within thy heart."**
> *- VC, v. 217*

In this scheme, *sat* names absolute being; *chit* names consciousness as the very nature of reality and Self, not a function of brain or mind; *ananda* names the intrinsic fullness of the Self, free from lack and dependence on objects. Advaita concentrates existence in one subject whose nature is being, consciousness, and bliss without a second.

The Mandukya Upanishad (MU, vv. 3–7) grounds this analysis in the three states (*avastha-traya*): waking, dream, and deep sleep — with turiya, the witness beyond all states, as ultimately real. This first-person ladder is not a map of Madhyasth Darshan's four developmental orders (§1.5); it analyses how temporal states appear and are witnessed from within. Witness analysis is developed in §2.6; the Sat-Chit-Ananda contrast with distributed coexistence is developed in §5.6.

2.3 Three tiers of reality

Advaita's standard framework separates three levels of reality. Private apparent errors (*pratibhasika*) include a rope mistaken for a snake. Shared empirical reality (*vyavahara*) governs bodies, physical laws, ethics, and scripture. Absolute truth (*paramartha*) is Brahman alone. The *mithya* doctrine and the three-tier framework are related but distinct tools (Editorial Notes); both are needed to read Advaita's ontology.

> **"A firm conviction of the mind to the effect that Brahman is real and the universe unreal, is designated as discrimination (Viveka) between the Real and the unreal."**
> *- VC, v. 20*
>
> **"The individual soul is itself and directly the Supreme Brahman, and nothing else."**
> *- VC, v. 216*

Level	What exists?	Status of world / error
Apparent (*pratibhasika*)	Rope-snake, dream objects, private errors	Sublated by waking or correction
Empirical (*vyavahara*)	Bodies, minds, Ishvara, causes, duties, scriptures, science	Shared, law-governed; operationally valid; sublated only by *brahma-jnana*

Level	What exists?	Status of world / error
Absolute (*paramartha*)	Brahman alone	World is *mithya*, dependent appearance

At *vyavahara*, the world is not unreal in the way a hallucination is; it is unreal relative to Brahman — like a dream relative to waking. The world is not sheer nothing, nor absolutely real; it is *mithya* — dependent appearance. Later Advaita systematises this as *anirvacaniya* ("indescribable" as either absolutely real or sheer nothing); Shankara uses "neither sat nor asat" language without that compound (Editorial Notes). That status matters when comparing Advaita's ethics and science with Madhyasth Darshan's perpetual world (§2.9, §6.3).

2.4 Maya, adhyasa, and causal doctrine

The multiplicity of the world rests on Brahman through superimposition (*adhyasa*) — like a snake seen on a rope. Cosmic Maya conceals Brahman's true nature (*avarana*) and projects the diversity of name-form (*vikshepa*). VC vv. 243–244 distinguish Maya (cosmic, Ishvara's superimposition) from Avidya (individual, the jiva's superimposition of body-mind on the Self). These are the structural concepts Madhyasth Darshan does not map to saturation (§5.7).

Advaita inherits satkaryavada from its Samkhya background: the effect pre-exists in the cause. The Chandogya clay teaching states the pattern:

> **"My dear, as by the knowledge of one lump of clay alone all things made of clay are known — for all transformation has speech as its basis, it being name, while clay alone is real — so, my dear, is this knowledge."**
> *- CU 6.1.4*

The *Vivekachudamani* compresses the same point:

> **"All modifications of clay, such as the jar, which are always accepted by the mind as real, are (in reality) nothing but clay. Similarly, this entire universe which is produced from the real Brahman, is Brahman Itself and nothing but That."**
> *- VC, v. 251*

At the empirical level, creation is vivartavada — apparent transformation of name-form on changeless Brahman. Brahman does not change; multiplicity is projected through Maya. The effect is not a real transformation of the cause. Creation is therefore not production from nothing; it is manifestation of names and forms on the basis of Brahman. Comparative causal doctrine across traditions is tabulated in §5.4.

The stock error of mistaking a rope for a snake illustrates Advaita's theory of error (*khyati-vada*): the snake is neither real (it vanishes on knowledge) nor utterly unreal (it was genuinely experienced), but a projection on a real substrate — the same structure Maya writ large applies to the world until Brahman is known. Madhyasth Darshan treats error as removable misidentification within a fully real world, not an indescribable appearance over a sole reality (§5.7).

2.5 Ishvara, jiva, and jagat at *vyavahara*

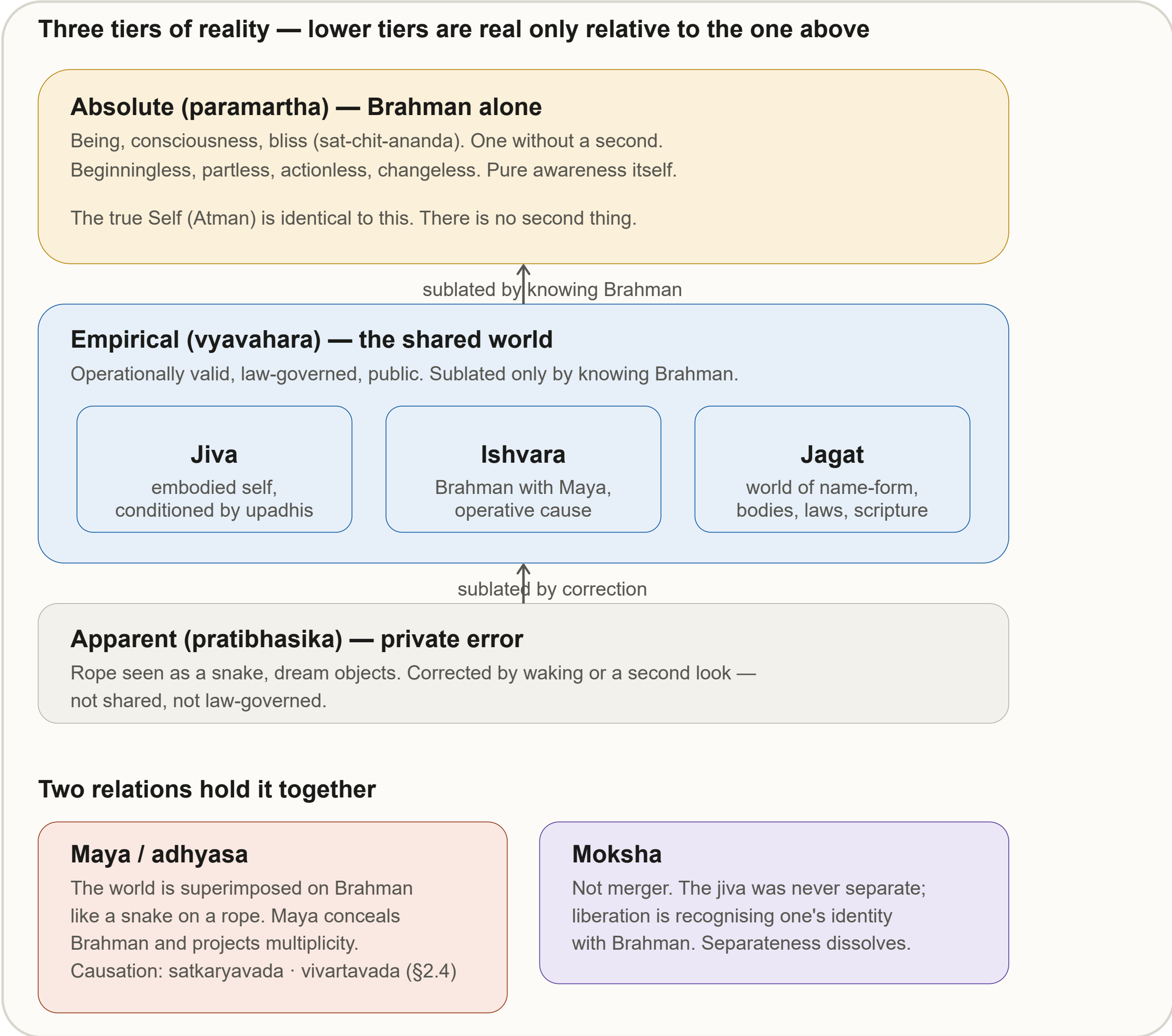
Because Advaita uses a three-tier framework, it posits several categories structurally necessary to explain the empirical world, even if they are ultimately sublated at the absolute level. These are the specific concepts compared against Madhyasth Darshan in §5.

Brahman is the sole absolute reality (*paramartha*) — pure, actionless awareness. Ishvara (Saguna Brahman) is Brahman associated with *Maya*, functioning as operative cause of name-form manifestation — not a creator *ex nihilo*. Ishvara is a *vyavahara*-level category sublated at *paramartha* (VC, v. 244):

> **"These two are the superimpositions of Ishwara and the Jiva respectively, and when these are perfectly eliminated, there is neither Ishwara nor Jiva."**
> *- VC, v. 244*

Jivatman (*jiva*) is the individual embodied soul — the true Self (*Atman*) conditioned by *upadhis* (limiting adjuncts such as body and mind), appearing as separate until realisation. Advaita's *Pancha Kosha* (five sheaths) language shares Upanishadic vocabulary with Madhyasth Darshan's order-and-plane exposition, but the two five-fold structures do not match one-to-one (§5.7.2); here the point is only that empirical individuality is conditioned, not that layers are discarded as unreal equipment.

Jagat (*nama-roopa*) is the physical universe of names and forms — operationally valid at *vyavahara*, ultimately *mithya* at *paramartha*. Bodies, minds, causal order, scripture, and science belong to this shared tier until *brahma-jnana* sublates the apparent separateness of the world from Brahman.



2.6 Witness-consciousness and the Self

The *Drig-Drishya-Viveka* (DDV) offers a rigorous seer-seen (*drig-drishya*) discrimination: whatever can be observed — body, sensations, thoughts — is "seen" and therefore not the seer (DDV, vv. 1–5). What remains is *Sakshin*, witness-consciousness — irreducible to matter and closer to Advaita's first-person route against physicalism than devotional VC passages alone (see §3.2, §5.6, §6.3).

> **"This body, O son of Kunti, is called the field; he who knows it is called the knower of the field."**
> *- BG, 13.1*
>
> **"Know also that I am the Knower of the field in all fields, and the knowledge of the field also am I."**
> *- BG, 13.2*

In the *Mandukya* analysis, *turiya* — the fourth, witness beyond waking, dream, and deep sleep — plays the same structural role: not another state among states, but the awareness in which states appear (MU, vv. 3–7; §2.2). At liberation, that witness is discovered as non-personal Brahman — one partless awareness without a second. Madhyasth Darshan agrees that the seer is not the seen body or brain-state, but locates the irreducible knower in immortal *jeevan* with active *gyan udghatan* (§1.13), not in a universal Self that finally absorbs all individuality (§5.6).

2.7 Conservation, origination, and temporality

Brahman does not begin: it is beginningless, partless, actionless, non-dual — outside temporal becoming (VC, v. 393). The universe as name-form has origination at the empirical level, but its ultimate truth is Brahman. Advaita's classical cosmology treats *vyavahara* as beginningless — creation and dissolution cycle without a first moment — so the empirical world is not a fleeting illusion in the manner of a private error (*pratibhasika*).

Advaita does not devote a separate chapter to *kaal*, but its framework implies a sharp division. At *paramartha*, only Brahman is absolutely real; temporality belongs to the empirical order. At *vyavahara*, past, present, and future, birth and death, and causal succession are operationally valid — the world is law-governed and shared (§2.3) — yet finally sublated when Brahman alone is known.

The *Mandukya* analysis of waking, dream, and deep sleep (§2.2) is a first-person route into how temporal states appear and are witnessed; the witness (*turiya*) is not another state among them. Madhyasth Darshan accepts the reality of cyclical development and unit-activity across orders (§§1.5–1.6) and refuses to sublate the world at the highest realisation; its account of *kaal* as duration of activity (§1.6.4) is therefore closer to a realist temporal ontology at every order, while still denying that time is a substance independent of activity. Comparison with Advaita's *trikaal* language and with Madhyasth Darshan's *trikaalabadh* coexistence claim (SB, p. 48) is developed in *Nature-Of-Time* (§2.2, §4).

2.8 Liberation and the knowledge path

Liberation (*moksha*) is not dissolution or merger of a real individual into Brahman. The jiva was never a separate entity; realisation is recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman, in which the illusion of separate individuality is dispelled. The classical identity formula is *tat tvam asi* — "That thou art" (CU 6.8.7, with Śaṅkara's bhāṣya); BS 1.1.2 treats the same doctrine systematically. VC compresses the pedagogy:

> **"There is neither death nor birth, neither a bound nor a struggling soul, neither a seeker after Liberation nor a liberated one – this is the ultimate truth."**
> *- VC, v. 574*
>
> **"The Supreme Brahman is, like the sky, pure, absolute, infinite, motionless and changeless, devoid of interior or exterior, the One Existence, without a second, and one's own Self."**
> *- VC, v. 393*

Advaita inherits the classical analysis of valid knowledge (*pramana*). For the supreme truth of non-duality, verbal testimony (*shabda*) — the revealed word of the Upanishads, processed through reasoning and meditation — is finally competent; perception and inference operate within the subject-object duality to be transcended. The supreme path is classically threefold: hearing the scriptures (*shravana*), reasoning over them (*manana*), and sustained meditation (*nididhyasana*), under a qualified teacher. First-person discrimination (*drig-drishya-viveka*, DDV) complements scripture by negating everything that presents itself as an object until only witnessing awareness remains. Full epistemological comparison: Knowledge, Knower, and Known §2.

Shankara's *Vivekachudamani* insists on ethical discipline as prerequisite to knowledge (VC, vv. 17–19). Ethics at *vyavahara* is developed as the section capstone in §2.9.

2.9 Ethics, *loka-sangraha*, and what realisation evidences

Advaita's charge that the world is *mithya* at *paramartha* does not make ethics untenable at the level where life is actually lived. At *vyavahara*, ethics and compassion remain fully valid; realisation of non-duality deepens rather than weakens them. The Bhagavad Gita, in Shankara's commentary, grounds social responsibility in *loka-sangraha* — holding the world together — and ordained duty:

> **"Perform your bounden duty, for action is superior to inaction."**
> *- BG, 3.8 (Shankara's commentary: niyatam kuru karma; the enlightened still act for the welfare of the world)*

What Advaita provisions at the empirical order must be distinguished from what realisation evidences at *paramartha*. Ethics, scripture, causal law, and compassionate action prepare the mind for *brahma-jnana*; they are binding where humans actually live. None of this guarantees that the world retains final ontological weight at the highest truth — that dispute is with Madhyasth Darshan's *jagat satat* (§1.14, §5.7).

Domain	Valid at *vyavahara*	Status at *paramartha*
Ethics and duty	Binding; deepens with realisation (VC, vv. 17–19; BG 3.8)	Sublated as means; non-dual identity remains
World and nature	Law-governed, shared, beginningless cosmology	*Mithya* — dependent appearance
Individual self	Real as embodied jiva under *upadhi*	Identical with Brahman; separateness dispelled
Relationships and society	*Loka-sangraha*, ordained action for world-welfare	Not ultimately separate from Brahman

Domain	Valid at *vyavahara*	Status at *paramartha*
Time and change	Past, present, future, birth and death operationally valid	Sublated when timeless Self is known

Realisation evidences identity with Brahman — the dispelled illusion of separate individuality, not Madhyasth Darshan's four outcomes of resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, and coexistence (§1.15). The enlightened still act for world-welfare at *vyavahara*; what changes at *paramartha* is ontological status, not the possibility of ethical living. Madhyasth Darshan's counter-reply — that robust ethics and beginningless *vyavahara* do not settle final world-realness — is developed in §6.3.

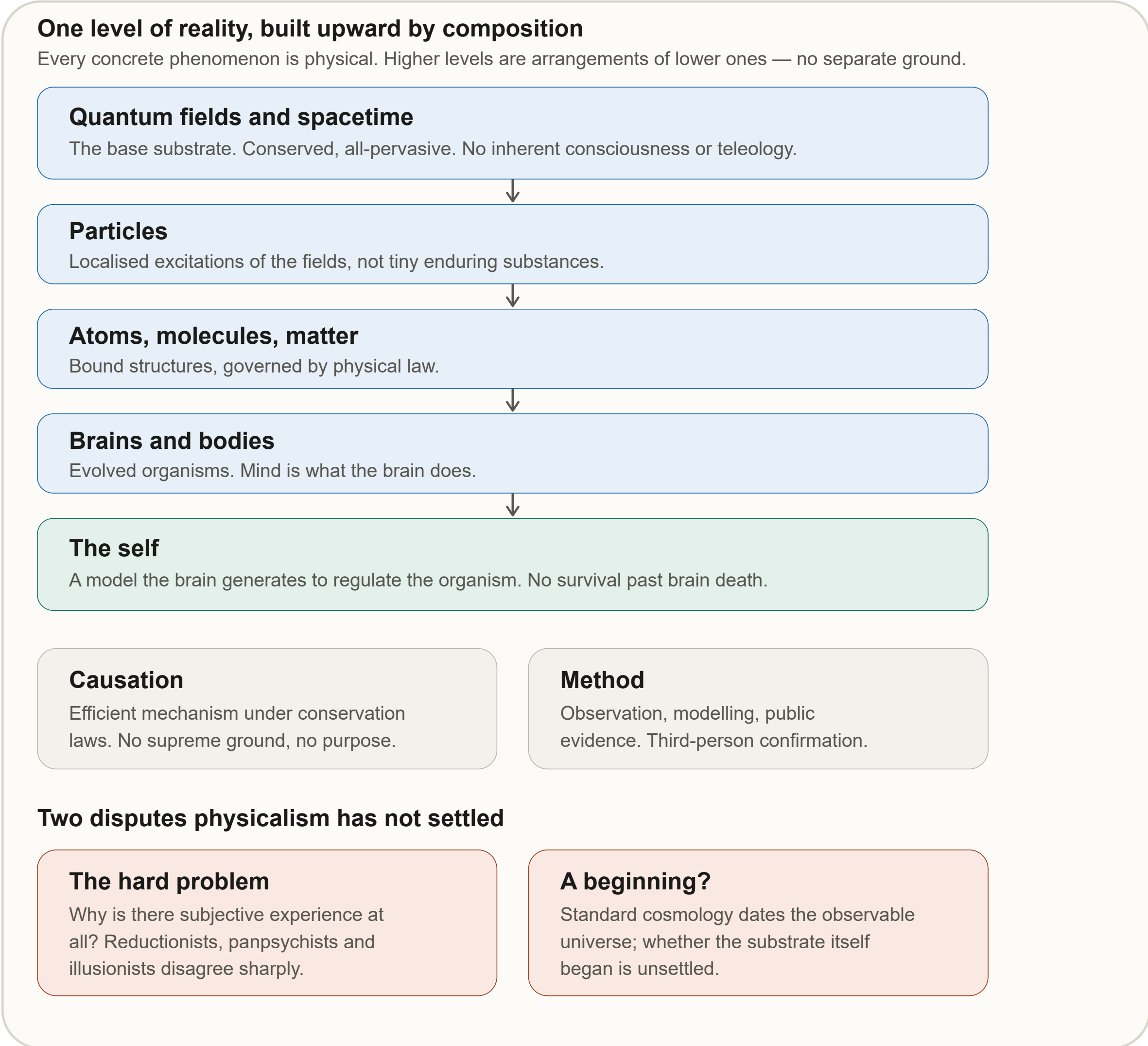
3. Modern Philosophical Approaches

Modern Western philosophy takes physical nature as baseline and disputes how mind, self, value, and the world's final status fit within it. The dominant materialist line holds that consciousness emerges from matter; metaphysical idealism has held the reverse. SB records that neither one-way emergence has been observed — what is evident is coexistence:

> **"In this course, metaphysical thought has held that matter arises from consciousness, whereas materialist thought has maintained that consciousness emerges from matter. Both ideologies have proposed numerous arguments, practices, and experiments in support of their claims. Yet, neither has matter been seen emerging from consciousness, nor consciousness emerging from matter. What is evident is that consciousness and matter are inseparably present."**
> *- SB, p. 48*

Madhyasth Darshan's own title — *Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad* (*Resolution Centred Materialism*) — reframes rather than abandons materialism. Against dialectical materialism, which treats struggle as the engine of history and science, SB proposes an orderliness-centred materialism in which nature remains real, saturated in Omnipresence, and oriented toward resolution rather than perpetual conflict (SB, pp. 8, 44). The Western debates below are the philosophical context that framing answers.

The section opens with physicalist ontology — what exists on a matter-first picture — and the hard problem with physicalist responses (panpsychism, emergentism, illusionism, eliminativism). Personal identity and persistence of the self follow, then origination, conservation, and world realism. Alternative Western ontologies supply partial analogues to ground-and-units coexistence. Method and evidential stakes close the account. The figure below summarises the physicalist architecture; time and cosmology are developed in [Nature of Time] and §4.



3.1 Physicalist ontology: what exists

> **"I take physicalism to be the view that every real, concrete phenomenon in the universe is...physical."**
> *- Strawson 2006, p. 2*

On this view, what exists are physical things, events, fields, organisms, brains, and processes. Minds and selves are not separate substances but functions, organisations, models, or processes of physical systems. Reductive physicalism holds that mental descriptions reduce without remainder to physical descriptions; non-reductive physicalism allows autonomous mental or functional levels while insisting that every concrete instance is still physical.

Methodological naturalism extends the picture into inquiry: the methods of the natural sciences — observation, experiment, modelling, public replication — are the standard for settling factual claims about the world. Scientific realism treats the physical world as mind-independent and law-governed: electrons, fields, and brains are not mere useful fictions but the furniture reality is made of, even when descriptions revise with theory change.

Constructivist and instrumentalist variants soften that claim; they remain minority positions within mainstream analytic philosophy.

Physicalism also asserts causal closure: every physical event has a sufficient physical cause, so no non-physical entity injects energy or intention into the nervous system (Kim 2005). That closure is what makes immortal *jeevan* working through the body a live dispute: if the brain is a closed physical system, a distinct sentient unit cannot be an independent causal partner without violating conservation or epiphenomenalism. Madhyasth Darshan locates *jeevan* as the sentient unit that works through the body, not as a ghost in the machine — but the physicalist still demands a third-person account of how that partnership is possible (§3.4, §6.4).

3.2 The hard problem and the first-person datum

> **"The really hard problem of consciousness is the problem of experience. When we think and perceive, there is a whir of information-processing, but there is also a subjective aspect."**
> *- Chalmers 1995, p. 3*
>
> **"It is widely agreed that experience arises from a physical basis, but we have no good explanation of why and how it so arises."**
> *- Chalmers 1995, p. 3*
>
> **"the fact that an organism has conscious experience at all means, basically, that there is something it is like to be that organism."**
> *- Nagel 1974, p. 1*

The hard problem is not whether brains correlate with experience — they do — but why any physical process should have an inside at all. Advaita's DDV offers a complementary first-person route: whatever can be observed — body, sensations, thoughts — is "seen" and therefore not the seer (DDV, vv. 1–5; §2.6). Madhyasth Darshan reads the explanatory gap as evidence that matter-only ontology is incomplete; physicalists often treat it as philosophically non-decisive — a gap in current theory, not proof of extra-physical being (§6.2.1, §6.4).

Some philosophers split the difference through property dualism: experience may be an irreducible property of certain physical systems while the laws governing matter remain intact. That fork preserves law-governed physics but adds a primitive experiential aspect Chalmers-style accounts find unavoidable. Madhyasth Darshan does not map cleanly onto property dualism: active *chaitanya* belongs to constitutionally complete *jeevan*, not to every complex physical system, and *satta* as *gyan* is not a property of particles (§1.13).

3.3 Physicalist responses: panpsychism, emergentism, illusionism

Physicalists who take the hard problem seriously divide into several families. Panpsychist physicalism (Strawson 2006) insists that experience cannot emerge from wholly non-experiential matter:

> **"Full recognition of the reality of experience, then, is the obligatory starting point for any remotely realistic version of physicalism."**
> *- Strawson 2006, p. 2*
>
> **"Experiential phenomena cannot be emergent from wholly non-experiential phenomena."**
> *- Strawson 2006, p. 12*
>
> **"Real physicalism, realistic physicalism, entails panpsychism."**
> *- Strawson 2006, p. 12*

This is closer to Madhyasth Darshan than reductive physicalism, since both refuse experience-from-dead-matter. Strawson's anti-emergence principle presses on the *gathanpurnata* account: if experience cannot emerge from the wholly non-experiential, sentience at completeness must be actualised from an ever-present ground, not produced from nothing — the latency reading developed in §6.2.1. Madhyasth Darshan differs in scope: it does not say every particle is a subject; active sentience is the status of constitutionally complete atoms only.

Panpsychism's combination problem bears directly on that restriction. If micro-experientiality is primitive, how do micro-subjects combine into a unified macro-subject? Strawson and other panpsychists leave this wound open; integrated information theory addresses it through structural integration, at the cost of pan-experiential commitments Madhyasth Darshan rejects (§4.2). Madhyasth Darshan's answer is different in kind: one constitutionally complete atom is already the sentient unit — *jeevan* is not assembled from many micro-minds but is a self-maintaining composite whose completeness is functional indivisibility (§§1.7, 1.6). Whether that avoids the combination problem or relocates it to the threshold itself is examined in §6.2.1.

Emergentism offers a middle path: new properties appear at organisational thresholds — digestion from chemistry, life from biochemistry, mind from neural complexity. Weak emergence treats higher-level patterns as real but dependent on lower-level physics; strong emergence would add causally novel properties irreducible to microphysics. Threshold grammar — a structural condition producing a qualitative level — is shared by emergentism, integrated information theory, and *gathanpurnata* (§6.2.1). Madhyasth Darshan denies strong emergence from dead matter while accepting qualitative change at constitutional completeness; latency names ever-present *gyan* in *satta* actualised at the threshold, not a new experiential ingredient from nothing.

At the opposite pole, illusionism (Frankish 2016) and eliminative materialism (Dennett 1991; Churchland 1986) preserve physicalism by denying or re-describing the datum the hard problem presses:

> **“Another approach, which holds that phenomenal consciousness is an illusion and aims to explain why it seems to exist.”**
> *- Frankish 2016, p. 1*
>
> **“illusionists deny the existence of phenomenal consciousness properly so-called, but do not deny the existence of a form of consciousness”**
> *- Frankish 2016, p. 8*

Illusionists retain access-consciousness, self-report, and functional control while treating “what it is like” as a misdescription of introspective models. Eliminativists go further: folk-psychological categories such as belief and desire may fail to refer, to be replaced by neuroscience. Madhyasth Darshan treats experience, valuation, aspiration, and realisation as activities of *jeevan*, not brain-model illusions. These views matter because they show how far naturalism will go to preserve a physicalist ontology — and because predictive-processing accounts (§4.1) offer a more sophisticated functionalist reply than bare elimination.

3.4 The self: personal identity and persistence

Physicalism’s answer to “does the individual self begin or end with the body?” is typically yes, in some version. The self is a biological and cognitive achievement — developing through embodiment, memory, and social recognition — and ceasing when brain function ends. Personal identity theory asks what, if anything, makes a person the same individual over time.

Locke’s classical account ties identity to psychological continuity — memory and connectedness of consciousness — rather than to sameness of material particles. Parfit’s later work argues that what matters in survival is psychological connectedness and continuity, not a further fact of identity: there is no deep entity beyond the stream of mental states that must persist (Parfit 1984; SEP Personal Identity). On reductionist readings, the question “is this the same *jeevan* after death?” has no fact of the matter beyond causal and psychological links — which bodily death breaks.

Substance views — rational soul as form of the body (§3.6.1), simple monads (§3.6.3) — preserve an enduring individual bearer. Madhyasth Darshan’s *jeevan* aligns with substance pluralism: a constitutionally complete, immortal unit that works through the body and persists across bodily death (§§1.7–1.8). Against physicalism, the dispute is not only metaphysical but causal: if the physical domain is closed, a non-physical *jeevan* is either epiphenomenal or a violation of closure. Self-model, predictive-processing, and integrated-information accounts in cognitive science (§§4.1–4.2) explain the sense of self without positing an immortal unit; Madhyasth Darshan’s counter is that regulation and representation do not settle what works through the brain (§6.4, §6.2.1).

3.5 Origination, conservation, and world realism

Western philosophy asks whether what exists had a beginning and whether particulars endure through change. Mainstream physicalism holds that local systems — organisms, stars, civilisations — begin and end, while fundamental physics may or may not require a cosmic beginning (§4.3). Conservation principles in physics treat certain quantities as preserved through transformation — a structural parallel to Madhyasth Darshan's claim that *vastu* persists through *roop*-change (§1.14, §4.4), though the categories differ.

Scientific realism answers "is the world finally real?" with yes for the physical universe: tables, fields, and brains are real mind-independent items suitable for public study. Idealism (Berkeley and successors) makes reality depend on perception or mind; nihilism denies that anything ultimately exists or matters. Both are outliers in contemporary analytic ontology but sharpen the stakes: Madhyasth Darshan's perpetual world (*jagat satat*) is neither mind-dependent appearance nor physical reduction alone — units and Omnipresence are co-eternally real (§1.14).

Philosophy of time adds a further fork. Block-universe eternalism treats past, present, and future as equally real coordinates; presentism privileges the present. Relational theories deny time as an independent container — time is the order of change among things. Madhyasth Darshan's *kaal* as duration of unit-activity is structurally closer to relational and process views than to block eternalism (*Nature of Time* §3). Cosmological questions about a beginningless substrate are developed in §4.3; the philosophical point here is that Western ontology has no consensus on whether existence as a whole begins, even when particular configurations do.

3.6 Alternative Western ontologies

Before the twentieth-century focus on mind and brain, Western metaphysics developed several ground-plus-particulars schemes that map partially onto Madhyasth Darshan's coexistence. They are ordered here from form-matter compounds through monism and pluralism to neutral ground — not as a historical timeline but as a ladder of analogues for §5.5.

3.6.1 Hylomorphism and soul-as-form

Aristotelian–Thomistic hylomorphism maps form (*forma*) onto matter (*materia*) so that a substance is the compound of both — not mere aggregation. Aquinas treats the rational soul as the form of the living body (*anima forma corporis*), giving a joint ontology of soul-and-body that parallels Madhyasth Darshan's *jeevan–shareer* joint form and the four-aspect unit signature (form, properties, essential nature, *dharma*) as what a unit is (§1.3). *Gathanpurnata* resembles substantial completion: a definite constitution at which a unit's essential nature is fully actualised. The divergences are sharp: Madhyasth Darshan's plural, immortal *jeevan* units, beginningless coexistence with *satta*, and saturation are not Aristotelian prime matter plus a single rational soul per body; yet the soul-as-form debate is a nearer cousin than process philosophy on individual persistence (SEP Form and Matter; Aquinas ST I, q. 75–76).

3.6.2 Spinoza: substance and modes

Spinoza's substance monism offers a closer analogue to *satta*-with-units than neutral monism. For Spinoza, one infinite substance (*Deus sive Natura*) has infinitely many modes — finite particulars expressing the one substance under different attributes (thought and extension). Madhyasth Darshan likewise keeps a pervasive ground and countless real units, but the contrast is decisive: Spinoza has one substance whose modes are not ontologically on a par with the whole; Madhyasth Darshan has co-eternal *satta* and *ikai*, each real in its own right, bound by saturation rather than modal expression of a single substance (Spinoza, *Ethics*, Part I, Props. 14–15; Part II, Def. 3). Spinoza's parallelism of thought and extension also differs from Madhyasth Darshan's tiered intelligibility: active *chaitanya* belongs only to *jeevan*, not to every mode of extension.

3.6.3 Leibniz: monads and harmony

Leibnizian monads offer a tighter analogue to plural immortal *jeevan* than Whitehead's occasions. Monads are simple, individual substances that mirror the whole from their perspective, do not interact by efficient causation but harmonize, and do not naturally perish. That plurality-with-harmony and individual immortality align structurally with many distinct *jeevan*-clouds saturated in Omnipresence (MVD, p. 13). The contrast: monads are windowless and perception-based; *jeevan* works through bodies in definite *sambandh* and fulfils relationships in nature's orders (Leibniz, *Monadology*, §§1–14, 78–81).

3.6.4 Process philosophy: occasions and becoming

Whitehead's process philosophy shares relational realism and refusal of nature bifurcation. His basic units are "actual entities" — "drops of experience, complex and interdependent" (Whitehead 1929, p. 28). The ultimate for Whitehead is creativity, the principle by which the many prior occasions become one new occasion; each occasion's concrescence — its growing-together from that inherited data — aims at intensity of experience before it perishes (Whitehead 1929). The key contrast remains persistence: Whitehead's occasions are momentary and "perpetually perish" subjectively, gaining "objective immortality" only as data for successors (Whitehead 1929, p. 44), whereas Madhyasth Darshan's *jeevan* is a persisting immortal individual. Process metaphysics also treats time as internal to becoming — a partial affinity with activity-based *kaal* (§3.5; *Nature of Time* §3.3).

> **"Actual entities 'perpetually perish' subjectively, but are immortal objectively."**
> *- Whitehead 1929, p. 44*

3.6.5 Neutral monism: common ground

Neutral monism (Russell, Mach) resembles Omnipresence as a reality that is neither mind nor matter but common ground. Russell holds that mind and matter are "composed of a neutral-stuff which, in isolation, is neither mental nor material" (Russell 1921, Lecture I). Mach likewise denies any "rift between the psychical and the physical": "There is but one kind of elements, out of which this supposed inside and outside are formed" (Mach 1914, Ch. XIV). The contrast: neutral monism typically builds mind and matter out of the neutral stuff, whereas Madhyasth Darshan keeps Omnipresence non-transforming and lets units be real in their own right rather than constructed from the ground.

> **"Both mind and matter are composed of a neutral-stuff which, in isolation, is neither mental nor material."**
> *- Russell 1921, Lecture I*
>
> **"There is no rift between the psychical and the physical, no inside and outside... There is but one kind of elements, out of which this supposed inside and outside are formed."**
> *- Mach 1914, Ch. XIV*

The Western schemes above — hylomorphism, substance monism, monads, process occasions, neutral ground — chiefly dispute how ground relates to particulars and whether individual selves endure. Process philosophy treats occasions as perpetually perishing; physicalism (§3.1–3.4) reads the self as embodied achievement rather than immortal substance. Those lines attack the permanence of the self while largely retaining the grammar of countable entities in relation — the same grammar §5.5 tabulates. Madhyamaka Buddhism is not part of §3's Western exposition, yet it bears directly on Madhyasth Darshan's saturation bond. Nagarjuna's critique of *svabhava* asks whether what exists only through mutual dependence can exist from its own side at all — challenging the coherence of mutual dependence itself, not only personal immortality. That pressure on coexistence is developed in §6.2.2 and explains why §5.5 omits Buddhism from the entity snapshot rather than adding a fifth column.

3.7 Method, evidence, and what philosophy establishes

Modern Western philosophy does not speak with one voice, but a typical physicalist constellation answers the study's framing questions as follows:

Question	Typical Western philosophical answer
What is existence?	Concrete physical reality — fields, spacetime, organisms — studied empirically; some add experience as fundamental (panpsychism) or neutral ground (neutral monism).
What exists?	Physical entities and their organisations; minds as processes; disputed whether experience is reducible, fundamental, or illusory.
Does what exists begin?	Particular systems begin and end; whether fundamentals had a first moment is unsettled (§3.5, §4.3).

Question	Typical Western philosophical answer
Does the individual self begin?	The self develops with body and brain; psychological continuity does not survive bodily death on standard physicalist accounts (§3.4).
Is the world finally real?	Yes, for scientific realism — the physical world is mind-independent; idealism and world-as-illusion are minority views.
Method of knowing	Observation, argument, public evidence; first-person datum acknowledged but not treated as existence-proof for immortal units.

What philosophy has established, on Madhyasth Darshan's reading, is a high evidential bar and a persistent exposed point: the hard problem shows that reductive matter-only accounts leave experience unexplained. What it has not established is immortal *jeevan*, constitutional completeness, or post-death continuity — an explanatory gap is not an existence proof (§6.4.1–6.4.2). Predictive processing and self-model theories (§4.1) deepen the physicalist reply without settling the ontological dispute (§6.4.3).

Mainstream science inherits this physicalist baseline and adds measurement, formal models, and institutional replication — the subject of §4.

4. Modern Scientific Approaches

Mainstream science inherits the physicalist baseline of §3 and adds measurement, formal models, and institutional replication. Where philosophy disputes mind, self, and world-realness in argument, science operationalises those disputes through instruments, datasets, and peer review. SB records that humans seek to live with evidence through experimentation, behaviour, and experience — not through argument alone:

> **"Humans inherently seek to live with evidence through experimentation, behaviour, and experience. They desire to achieve comprehensive resolution — across various aspects, perspectives, directions, dimensions, and contexts of time and place."**
> *- SB, p. 44*

Madhyasth Darshan treats public science as one leg of that evidence-seeking — strong on mechanism, prediction, and correction. It adds realisation and conduct as further evidence of understanding — the epistemic frame developed in Knowledge, Knower, and Known. JV notes that the human body is provisioned to evidence understanding, not merely to house brain activity (JV, p. 59).

The section opens with mind, self, and predictive processing in neuroscience, then consciousness-science rivals (IIT, autopoiesis, and competing programs). Cosmology asks whether the universe began; quantum fields and conservation ask what persists through transformation;

spacetime and entropy contrast physical time and disorder with *kaal* and *vyavastha*. Evolution and ecology treat adaptation and cooperation as biological mechanisms. Method and what science establishes close the section. Time physics is in [*Nature of Time*]; limits of science are critiqued in §6.4.

4.1 Mind, self, and predictive processing

Self-model theories in cognitive science (Metzinger 2003) build on the physicalist premise that the self is not an immortal unit but a predictive model the brain generates to regulate the organism:

> **"minimal selfhood emerges as the result"**
> *- Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 1*
>
> **"these accounts propose to 'understand the elusive sense of minimal self in terms of having internal models that successfully predict or match the sensory consequences of our own movement, our intentions in action, and our sensory input'."**
> *- Limanowski and Blankenburg 2013, p. 3*

The most developed recent form is predictive processing and active inference: the brain as a hierarchically deep generative model that minimizes prediction error (surprise) by updating beliefs and guiding action (Friston 2010; Clark 2016). On this view, valuation, aspiration, the sense of being a continuous self, and the felt reality of the world are not dismissed as mere illusion; they are functionally real control structures — layered expectations that keep the organism viable. Seth (2021) extends the picture: conscious selfhood is the brain's "best guess" about its own embodiment, a controlled hallucination tuned by interoceptive and sensorimotor evidence.

For Madhyasth Darshan this is nearly the opposite of the *jeevan* ontology: the self is a real sentient unit using the body, not a model generated by embodied prediction. Science's operational criterion for when that regulative process ends is brain death — irreversible loss of whole-brain function. On that standard, the person ceases when neural integration fails; there is no post-death survival of the self for medicine to measure. Madhyasth Darshan answers the self-model rival through latency: sentience is actualised from the ever-present ground at constitutional completeness, not generated as a new ingredient from dead matter (§6.2.1). Predictive models explain how a body self-regulates; they do not settle whether the regulator is only neural tissue or a distinct *jeevan* working through the brain (§6.4.3, §5.3.5).

4.2 Consciousness science: IIT, autopoiesis, and rival programs

Integrated Information Theory (IIT) proposes that consciousness corresponds to integrated information (Φ) in a system, with a quantitative threshold producing a qualitative difference — "an experience is a maximally irreducible conceptual structure" (Tononi 2012). IIT is a useful physicalist mirror of threshold grammar: like *gathanpurnata*, it ties consciousness to a structural condition. The contrasts are decisive: IIT is pan-experiential at the fundamental level in many formulations, operational and measurement-oriented, and silent on immortal individual units or coexistential ground; Madhyasth Darshan restricts active sentience to constitutionally complete reflector atoms and locates latency in *satta* as *gyan* (§§1.13, 6.6).

Autopoiesis (Maturana and Varela) treats living organisation as a self-producing network that maintains its boundary and identity through continuous metabolism — "a machine organised as a network of processes of production of components" that "continuously regenerate and realize the network that produces them" (Maturana and Varela 1980, p. 78). This parallels Madhyasth Darshan's emphasis on self-maintaining constitutional completeness and bio-order cyclicality, but autopoiesis describes organizational closure in biology, not the ontological saturation of units in *satta* or the latency of sentience at *gathanpurnata*.

Contemporary consciousness science has no settled account. Competing programs — integrated information, global neuronal workspace, higher-order theory, recurrent processing, and others — offer different structural criteria for when experience is present. Adversarial tests have partly supported and partly challenged leading theories without producing consensus. For this study, the point is structural: science shares threshold grammar with *gathanpurnata* but offers no third-person metric for latency in *satta* or for immortal *jeevan* (§6.2.1).

4.3 Cosmology and cosmic beginnings

The ΛCDM standard model treats the observable universe as expanding from a hot dense state roughly 13.8 billion years ago — a cosmic beginning for the universe we can observe. That model is extraordinarily successful on large-scale structure, nucleosynthesis, and the cosmic microwave background. It does not by itself answer whether existence as a whole began, or only this cosmic epoch.

Several non-singular research programs explore a beginningless physical substrate from which local universes or phases arise. Loop quantum cosmology replaces the initial singularity with a "bounce" from a prior contracting phase (Ashtekar and Singh 2011). Penrose's conformal cyclic cosmology posits successive aeons, each with its own big bang (Penrose 2010). Eternal inflation treats our observable patch as one bubble in a potentially infinite multiverse (Guth 2007). These are competing speculative programs, not consensus — the most this comparison claims is conceptual resonance with Madhyasth Darshan's claim that nature (*prakriti*) is perpetual (*satat*), not proof that *jagat satat* is established by cosmology (§1.14, §6.2.5).

4.4 Quantum fields, particles, and conservation

Particle–antiparticle annihilation and pair creation are not passages into or out of absolute non-being. In quantum field theory, particles are localized excitations of conserved, all-pervasive fields, and annihilation transforms one excitation (matter) into another (radiation) under strict conservation laws (Weinberg 1995). This is broadly consonant with

Madhyasth Darshan's claim that fundamental reality (*vastu*) is conserved while configurations (*roop*) transform (§1.14) — though the alignment must be handled with care.

What persists in QFT are field configurations and conserved quantities; a "particle" is a localized excitation, not a tiny enduring substance. Madhyasth Darshan's *vastu* names an underlying reality that survives every *roop*-change in countable units with *dharma* saturated in Omnipresence. The parallel is structural, not identity of category: fields are mathematical-physical entities governed by equations, not bounded *ikai* in coexistence.

Comparing *satta* to a physical field is misleading for the same reason. A dynamical field carries energy-momentum, exerts force, and propagates waves — nothing like the actionless (*kriya-shunya*), non-transforming *satta* (§1.2). The nearest physical analogue — non-dynamical background geometry or the quantum vacuum ground state — captures only that units depend on a uniform ground; it drops the darshan's second half: uniform energy stays unmanifest without unit activity (§1.2). Energy conservation itself is subtle in General Relativity: it is tied, via Noether's theorem, to time-symmetry that need not hold globally in an expanding spacetime (Carroll 2010).

4.5 Spacetime, entropy, and order

Modern physics treats spacetime as a dynamical entity — it can expand, curve, and in some models exhibit local beginnings. Madhyasth Darshan treats *kaal* as the duration of unit-activity, numerically reckoned by humans within existence (§1.6.4; SB, pp. 65, 251; MVD, pp. 34, 195) — not an independent cosmic container. Omnipresence is timeless as non-transforming ground. The contrast is over whether temporality belongs to the ground of reality or only to transforming units, and over whether spacetime is fundamental physics or derivative of measurement conventions on activity. Relational and process philosophies of time (§3.6.4; §3.5) share some structural affinity with activity-based *kaal*; block-universe eternalism does not. Comparative detail: *Nature-Of-Time*.

Thermodynamic entropy describes a statistical arrow toward disorder in closed systems. Madhyasth Darshan asserts inherent orderliness (*vyavastha*) at every order, with development toward greater organisation when units are in their natural state. These are not straightforward opposites — biological and ecological systems can increase local order at the cost of entropy elsewhere — but they use different notions of "order." The second law neither supports nor refutes coexistence orderliness.

4.6 Evolution, ecology, and cooperation

Natural selection is mainstream biology's mechanism for adaptation: heritable variation plus differential reproduction produces organisms fitted to their environments. On this picture, bodies, brains, and behavioural strategies — including cooperation — are products of evolutionary history, not eternal units with ontologically fixed *dharma*.

Madhyasth Darshan's *niyati-kram* asserts a fixed, guaranteed order of emergence — material to pranic to animal to knowledge on Earth (§1.5) — whereas evolutionary biology explains adaptation through contingent variation and selection. The tension is structural: the same four orders can be read as MD's definite plateaus or as science's historically produced taxonomies and lineages; this study does not resolve that dispute (§6.2.6).

Ecology treats organisms as nodes in interdependent networks: energy flows, nutrient cycles, symbiosis, and competition. Cooperation among conspecifics and across species is widely studied as an evolved strategy — kin selection, reciprocity, mutualism — not as ontologically real *mulya* (*value*) fulfilled in definite *sambandh* (§1.4). Madhyasth Darshan does not deny biological interdependence; it denies that ecological cooperation replaces inherent value-recognition and fulfilment at the knowledge order. At the human–nature relation, MD names utility (*upyogita*) and art (*kala*) — making natural abundance usable and enhancing that usefulness through aesthetic labour (MVD pp. 56–57, 324; JV p. 77) — not a generic claim that value is "structurally real" without category. Science explains how cooperative behaviour arises; MD claims complementarity, essentiality-as-value, and utility–art on nature are already structurally real in coexistence (§1.4).

Against all of these, Madhyasth Darshan makes stronger metaphysical claims: coexistence is eternal, units are not annihilated, and *jeevan* is immortal. That eternalism is consistent with conservation principles and beginningless cosmological models; individual immortality and constitutional completeness are distinct commitments examined in §6.2.

4.7 Method, evidence, and what science establishes

Modern science does not speak with one voice across every specialty, but a typical physical-science constellation answers the study's framing questions as follows:

Question	Typical scientific answer
What is existence?	Dynamical spacetime, quantum fields, and their excitations — studied through observation, experiment, and mathematical models.
What exists?	Matter, energy, fields, organisms, brains; minds as functional/processual features of neural systems.
Does what exists begin?	The observable universe ~13.8 Ga on ΛCDM; whether any substrate is beginningless is unsettled (§4.3).
Does the individual self begin?	Self develops with brain and body; brain death ends the person operationally; no measured post-death continuity (§4.1).
Is the world finally real?	Yes — the physical world is mind-independent and law-governed, publicly testable.
Method of knowing	Observation, instrumentation, modelling, replication, peer review; third-person confirmation.

What science has established is precise mechanism, prediction, and correction across domains from particle physics to neuroscience. What it has not established — on Madhyasth Darshan's reading — is immortal *jeevan*, constitutional completeness at *gathanpurnata*, or post-death continuity of a sentient unit. An explanatory gap in the hard problem (§3.2) is not an existence proof for *jeevan*; predictive accuracy alone does not settle whether the regulator is only neural or a distinct unit working through the brain (§6.4.3, §5.3.5). The comparative synthesis begins in §5.

5. Comparison

Sections §§1–4 stated Madhyasth Darshan, Advaita Vedanta, and modern philosophical and scientific approaches on their own terms. This section synthesizes those expositions. The comparison runs on seven axes — ground, world realism, self and survival, causation and beginninglessness, time, method, ethics and purpose — summarized in §5.2. Six of them are developed in prose in §5.3; time is treated separately in *Nature of Time*. Three fault lines cut across those axes: whether existence is exhausted by matter and mechanism; whether the world retains final ontological weight; whether an immortal individual self is established. Madhyamaka's critique of intrinsic nature — previewed in §3.6 — presses the coherence of mutual dependence itself rather than only the permanence of the self; §6.2.2 treats it as the gravest philosophical threat to coexistential realism. §5.1 names the pairwise alliances first; §§5.4–5.7 then deepen causation, entity structure, Sat-Chit-Ananda, and the Advaita-specific structural fork.

5.1 Where the alliances fall

No single tradition wins every dispute. Three pairwise patterns clarify what each view shares with and denies to the others:

Madhyasth Darshan and Advaita against physicalism. Both refuse to treat existence as merely physicochemical matter. Consciousness, value, and the self are not exhaustively explained as brain-generated epiphenomena. Against reductive materialism, both hold that something more than bare mechanism is required — though they disagree sharply on what that "more" is. Advaita's *Sakshin* / *turiya* route and Madhyasth Darshan's constitutionally complete *jeevan* both reject the predictive self-model picture in which the self is only a hierarchical brain construct (§4.1); Madhyasth Darshan adds latency in *satta* as *gyan* actualised at constitutional completeness (§1.13), not experience generated from dead matter.

Madhyasth Darshan and science against Advaita. Both treat the world as real and worth studying. Matter, bodies, relationships, and ecological order are not finally *mithya* or preparatory illusion. Against world-negating non-dualism, both insist that nature and society have final weight — though science does not affirm Omnipresence or immortal *jeevan*. Quantum field conservation and public cosmology treat physical nature as law-governed and investigable (§4.4); Madhyasth Darshan's *jagat satat* agrees that the world is perpetual and real at the highest truth, against Advaita's *paramartha* sublation of name-form (§2.4).

Advaita and science against Madhyasth Darshan. Both set a high bar for claims that exceed public evidence. Advaita holds that separate individuality was never ultimately real (VC, v. 574); science treats the self as a biological process that ceases at brain death (§4.1). Against Madhyasth Darshan's eternal distinct sentient units, both deny — on different grounds — that an immortal individual self is established.

Each pair agrees on something the third denies. Comparative clarity depends on naming which question is at stake: matter-only reduction, world-reality, or individual immortality.

5.2 Cross-tradition summary

The table below aggregates modern physicalist approaches — the philosophical baseline of §3 and the scientific operationalizations of §4 — in one column. Where philosophy and science diverge in entity type (hylomorphism versus quantum fields, witness versus predictive self-model), §5.5 splits them into separate columns.

Question	Madhyasth Darshan	Advaita Vedanta	Modern physicalist approaches	Further detail
What is existence?	Eternally present coexistence: Omnipresence plus all units held in it.	Brahman / Existence alone, one without a second.	Concrete physical reality, studied empirically.	§5.3.1; §5.5; §5.6
What exists?	Omnipresence and real units, sentient and insentient.	Brahman alone (absolutely); world *mithya* at *paramartha*.	Usually the physical; experience disputed.	§5.3.1–5.3.2; §5.5
Does it begin?	No — what exists does not come from non-existence; bodies and configurations do.	Brahman does not begin; name-form at *vyavahara*.	Particular systems begin and end; cosmology unsettled.	§5.3.4; §5.4
Does the individual self begin?	*Jeevan* does not begin at birth or die with the body.	*Jiva* is ultimately Brahman; separate individuality dispelled at realisation (VC, vv. 244, 574).	Self develops as biological/cognitive process.	§5.3.3; §5.6

Question	Madhyasth Darshan	Advaita Vedanta	Modern physicalist approaches	Further detail
What is time?	Duration of unit-activity; human numerical reckoning within existence; *satta* timeless as ground (§1.6.4).	Brahman beyond temporal becoming; time valid at *vyavahara*, sublated at *paramartha*.	Spacetime as dynamical physical structure; philosophy of time contested.	*Nature of Time*
Is the world finally real?	Yes. "Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual."	Empirically valid but ultimately *mithya*.	Yes, as physical reality.	§5.3.2; §5.7
Method of knowing	Study → experiment and practice → realisation with evidence in conduct.	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination.	Observation, modelling, public evidence.	§5.3.5
Ethical consequence	Humane conduct evidences understanding of coexistence.	Ethics prepares the mind for liberation.	Ethics via naturalism, social/normative theory.	§5.3.6; §5.5

5.3 Key contrasts

5.3.1 Ground and existence

The deepest question is what existence itself is. Madhyasth Darshan holds eternally present coexistence (*saha-astitva*): formless Omnipresence (*satta*) and countless real units (*ikai*) held in saturation, neither made from the other (§1.2). Advaita Vedanta holds Brahman alone — being, consciousness, bliss, one without a second — as absolutely real; the manifold world is dependent appearance at the highest truth (§2.3). Modern physicalist approaches take concrete physical reality as baseline: fields, organisms, brains, and processes, studied empirically without positing an actionless omnipresent ground (§3.1). Western ground-plus-particulars schemes — hylomorphism, Spinoza's substance and modes, Leibniz's monads, process creativity, neutral monism (§3.7) — supply partial analogues to coexistence; none names saturation or constitutional *jeevan*. The fork between Madhyasth Darshan and Advaita on ground is developed in §5.6–5.7; the entity snapshot is in §5.5.

5.3.2 World realism

Whether the world retains final ontological weight divides Madhyasth Darshan from Advaita while aligning it partially with scientific realism. Madhyasth Darshan holds *jagat satat* — the world is perpetual and real at every level of realisation: "Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual" (MVD, p. 13; §1.14). Advaita's three-tier scheme (*paramartha*, *vyavahara*, *pratibhasika*) makes the empirical world robust for ethics and daily life yet mithya — neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing — at *paramartha* (§§2.3–2.4). Modern scientific realism treats the physical world as mind-independent and law-governed (§3.1); that is not the same as Omnipresence, but it allies with Madhyasth Darshan against world-negation at the highest truth. Advaita's fair reply — beginningless *vyavahara*, *loka-sangraha*, preparatory ethics (§2.9) — does not settle whether the world survives sublation; §5.7 treats *mithya* as the unmappable category.

5.3.3 Self, consciousness, and survival

On selfhood, Madhyasth Darshan and Advaita stand together against reductive physicalism and apart from each other on individuality. Madhyasth Darshan holds many immortal, constitutionally complete *jeevan* units — real sentient atoms that work through the body, actualised from latency in *satta* at *gathanpurnata* (§§1.6–1.7, 1.13). Advaita holds the true Self is Brahman; separate *jivatman* is *vyavahara* superimposition dispelled at liberation (VC, vv. 244, 574; §2.5). Modern approaches treat the self as brain-generated process: predictive self-models, integrated-information thresholds, or evolved cognitive agents, with brain death as the operational end of the person (§4.1). Physicalist rivals — strong emergence, panpsychism, illusionism (§3.2–3.3) — dispute how experience arises but not, in the mainstream, post-death survival of a distinct unit. The Sat-Chit-Ananda distribution of consciousness across ground and *jeevan* is tabulated in §5.6.

5.3.4 Causation and beginninglessness

Causation determines how each tradition treats origination. Madhyasth Darshan denies origination from non-existence (*abhava*): *satta* is *mahakaran* — sustaining ground, not efficient trigger — and units change through the inseparable triad *shram–gati–parinam* (§§1.2–1.6). Advaita inherits *satkaryavada* (effect in cause) and, at the empirical level, vivartavada: changeless Brahman, apparent transformation of name-form through *Maya* (§2.4). Modern physicalism uses efficient causation under conservation laws; particular systems begin and end, while a beginningless substrate remains cosmologically unsettled (§4.3). Madhyasth Darshan's slogan — Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual — preserves real unit transformation where Advaita projects and physicalism dynamizes fields. Full comparative detail is in §5.4.

5.3.5 Method and what counts as evidence

The three systems do not merely give different answers; they use different criteria for knowing. Madhyasth Darshan treats knowing as a staged path: (1) study — logical comparison through observation, examination, and survey (MVD pp. 88, 115); (2) experiment and practice — behaviour and work as trial (MVD p. 88; SB p. 44); (3) realisation with evidence — *anubhav* closing the MVD p. 12 chain so understanding becomes evident in humane living and tradition. Deep fixity in conduct follows realisation-based study rather than argument alone (MVD p. 88; Ch. 17). Advaita reserves ultimate competence for scripture processed through reasoning and contemplative discrimination — DDV, *shravana–manana–nididhyasana* (§2.8). Modern science trusts observation, modelling, replication, and public measurement (§4).

Tradition	Method	Adequate for
Madhyasth Darshan	Study → experiment and practice → realisation with evidence in conduct	Coexistence as lived evidence; conduct as proof of understanding
Advaita	Scripture, reasoning, contemplative discrimination (DDV, VC)	Self as Brahman; sublation of *mithya*
Physicalism	Observation, modelling, public evidence	Mechanism, prediction, third-person confirmation

To that extent the traditions are partially incommensurable — no single neutral tribunal settles them. Comparative work can still test internal consistency, fit with public knowledge, and responsible distinction of posits from bare assertion. Full epistemology and the standards of realisation as proof: *Knowledge, Knower, and Known* §§1.6–1.8.

5.3.6 Ethics and life's purpose

Telos follows ontology. Madhyasth Darshan seeks awakened coexistence (*jagriti*): realisation of coexistence expressed as resolved humane conduct (*manaviya aacharan*) in society, with ontologically real values (*mulya*) and relationships (*sambandh*) (§§1.4, 1.15). Advaita seeks liberation (*moksha*): recognition of identity with Brahman, in which the illusion of separate self is dispelled; ethics at *vyavahara* purifies the mind for that end (§2.9). Modern physicalist approaches explain ethics through evolution, psychology, social contract, or naturalized normativity; life's purpose, where acknowledged, is adaptation, flourishing, or human-constructed meaning (§§3, 4.6). Madhyasth Darshan ties fulfilment to conduct-evidence; Advaita to sublation; science to mechanism and survival — three different standards for whether a life is well-lived.

5.4 Causal doctrine: *Satkaryavada*, *Vivartavada*, and Madhyasth Darshan

Causal doctrine is the deepest structural difference on the beginninglessness axis (§5.2, “Does it begin?”; §5.3.4).

Advaita (Sankhya inheritance): *Satkaryavada* — the effect pre-exists in the cause (clay-pot, VC v. 251). At the empirical level, creation is *vivartavada*: apparent transformation of name-form on changeless Brahman — the effect is not a real transformation of the cause. Brahman does not change; multiplicity is projected through *Maya*.

Madhyasth Darshan: Denies single-material-cause reduction and linear efficient-cause chains. *Satta* is *mahakaran* (supreme sustaining cause), not efficient cause (§1.6.4). Units change through the single activity triad *shram–gati–parinam*, read toward completeness in sentient nature through projection, reflection, and *samadhan*, with circular activity, order-specific cyclicality, and *sanskar*-mediated human cycles. Conservation of *vastu* through *roop*-change resembles *parinamavada* at the unit level, but the full picture is not reducible to “*parinamavada*-like” alone.

Modern physicalism: Strict efficient causation — mechanism, fields, conservation laws. Origination of particular systems is compatible with a beginningless substrate (§4.3); no teleology or supreme ground.

Aspect	Advaita	Madhyasth Darshan	Modern physicalism
Effect in cause?	Yes (*satkaryavada*)	Units eternal; change is transformation within coexistence	Conservation laws; particles as field excitations
Cause transforms?	No (Brahman changeless; *vivarta*)	*Satta* non-transforming; units transform	Fields/spacetime dynamical
Origination vs change	Name-form originates at *vyavahara*; Brahman does not begin	No origination from *abhava*; development and awakening	Local systems begin/end; substrate unsettled

5.5 Entity comparison

The table compares primary entities across the four traditions developed in §§1–4. §3 supplied philosophy analogues (hylomorphism, monads, physicalism, process, panpsychism); §4 supplied science operationalizations (quantum fields, predictive self-models, ecology). The split into Contemporary Philosophy and Modern Science columns appears here — not in §5.2 — where those traditions genuinely diverge in entity type. Abrahamic and Dvaita ontologies are outside scope.

Buddhist traditions, especially Madhyamaka, are omitted methodologically, not because they are irrelevant. Madhyamaka denies intrinsic *svabhava* and *anatta* denies an enduring self; it challenges whether the table’s enduring-entity grammar applies at all rather than answering it in parallel columns. Anatta and Nagarjuna's critique belong in §6.2.2 — the proper venue for the gravest philosophical threat to immortal distinct *jeevan*.

Entity Category / Attribute	**Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)**	**Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)**	**Contemporary Philosophy (Process, Physicalist, Panpsychist)**	**Modern Science (Physics, CogSci, Cosmology)**
Cosmic Ground	Omnipresence (*Satta / Space*): Pervasive, formless, actionless energy (*kriya-shunya*). Inherent energy and regulation in units through saturation (*samprikt*); uniform energy manifests as activity only through units (§1.2).	Brahman: The single, non-dual absolute reality (*Sat-Chit-Ananda*). The world is *mithya* (dependent appearance) at *paramartha*.	Form + Matter (Hylomorphism): Substantial form actualising matter. Substance + modes (Spinoza): One *Deus sive Natura*, finite modes. Monad field (Leibniz): Simple substances in harmony. Creativity (Process): the ultimate by which prior occasions become one new occasion. Neutral Stuff (Neutral Monism): Common element.	Spacetime & Quantum Fields: Dynamic, physical substrate. No inherent consciousness or teleology.

Entity Category / Attribute	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy (Process, Physicalist, Panpsychist)	Modern Science (Physics, CogSci, Cosmology)
Individual Self / Sentience	Jeevan: A constitutionally complete, immortal atom (*gathanpurna parmanu*). Many distinct, eternal *jeevan* exist.	Jivatman / Atman: Individuality (*jivatman*) is a *vyavahara* superimposition (VC, v. 244). The true Self (*Atman*) is identical to Brahman.	Rational Soul as Form (Hylomorphism): Form of the living body. Monad (Leibniz): Simple, mirroring, immortal substance. Self-Model (Physicalist): Evolved cognitive model. Φ-threshold system (IIT): Integrated information.	Predictive Self / Cognitive Agent: Brain-generated hierarchical model (§4.1). No survival post-death.
Material Reality / Body	Jada Units / Shareer: Real, perpetual, transforming matter. Composes the body, which acts as the vehicle for *jeevan*.	Nama-Roopa / Mithya: Form and name; robust at *vyavahara*; sublated at *paramartha*.	Physical Matter: The primary concrete reality (Physicalism); or the outer aspect of experiential units (Panpsychism).	Matter & Energy: Consolidated excitations of quantum fields. Governed by conservation laws. Perpetual in base fields.
Relationships & Moral Order	Coexistence / Complementarity: Inherent, ontologically real values (*mulya*) and orderliness (*vyavastha*) through the regulation ladder (§1.11).	Ethics at *vyavahara*: Valid to purify the mind; *loka-sangraha* (BG); sublated at *paramartha*.	Social / Internal Relations: Relationality constitutes the self (Process); or evolutionary strategies for survival (Physicalism).	Ecology & Cooperation: Interdependent biological networks. Cooperation is an evolved behavioural strategy.

Entity Category / Attribute	Madhyasth Darshan (Co-existentialism)	Advaita Vedanta (Non-Dualism)	Contemporary Philosophy (Process, Physicalist, Panpsychist)	Modern Science (Physics, CogSci, Cosmology)
Primary Causation	Cyclical mutually-sustaining causation (§§1.2–1.6): *Satta* as *mahakaran*; single *shram–gati–parinam* triad with sentient unfolding; cyclical activity returning units to natural state in give–take complementarity (*svabhav gati*), not vicious circular grounding; *sanskar*-mediated human cycles.	Vivartavada: Apparent transformation on changeless Brahman (*satkaryavada* background).	Efficient / Creative Causation: Physical mechanisms (Physicalism); or “concrescence” (Process).	Physical Causation: Mathematical laws, conservation, entropy.
Ultimate Purpose / Realisation	Awakening (*Jagriti*): Realisation of coexistence, leading to resolved humane conduct (*manaviya aacharan*) in society.	Liberation (*Moksha*): Recognition of identity with Brahman; illusion of separate self dispelled (VC, v. 574).	Flourishing / Adaptation: Cognitive adaptability (Physicalism); intensity of experience in each occasion (Process).	Survival & Adaptation: Natural selection; active inference / free-energy minimisation (Friston 2010; §4.1); homeostasis.

5.6 The Sat-Chit-Ananda contrast, distributed

Advaita’s Sat-Chit-Ananda and Madhyasth Darshan’s coexistence can sound alike — both speak of being, consciousness, and fulfilment. The contrast is over what those words name and whether the world survives them (§§5.3.1–5.3.3).

For Advaita, *sat*, *chit*, *ananda* are three names for one ultimate reality without a second; the world is finally *mithya*. For Madhyasth Darshan, the same vocabulary is distributed across coexistence, not compressed into one subject:

Concept	Advaita Vedanta (Unified Non-Dualism)	Madhyasth Darshan (Distributed Coexistence)
Sat (Being)	Brahman alone is Sat; the world is a dependent appearance ultimately negated.	Beingness (*astitva*) is coexistence of formless Omnipresence and countless real units.
Chit (Consciousness)	Pure awareness, identical to the inner Self; the world of names/forms is inert.	Omnipresence is pervasive knowledge/condition-of-intelligibility (§1.13), but active sentience (*chaitanya*) belongs to the *jeevan* unit.
Ananda (Bliss)	Intrinsic nature of Brahman; sensory joy is a distorted reflection.	Harmony realised within awakened *jeevan* — bliss as buddhi–*atma* harmony and humane conduct — not Brahman's intrinsic *ananda* alone (§1.8).

The *chit* row and the DDV route sharpen a further fork. Both traditions refuse to reduce the first person to observed brain-states; both distinguish seer from seen. Advaita's *Sakshin* / *turiya*, once discriminated, is Brahman itself — impersonal, universal, and finally without a second knower. Madhyasth Darshan's knower is constitutionally complete *jeevan*: many distinct units, each capable of *gyan udghatan* when awakened (§1.13). Against physicalism the two stand together; against each other the dispute is whether irreducible awareness is one or many, impersonal ground or immortal persons-in-coexistence.

Modern philosophy has no parallel formula: it may treat experience as physical, fundamental, or illusory, but it does not name existence as Sat-Chit-Ananda or as coexistence.

5.7 Advaita structural fork: analogues and unmappable categories

Advaita Vedanta and Madhyasth Darshan arise from different core commitments — non-dualism versus co-existentialism — yet share Upanishadic vocabulary. Four Advaita entities find close analogues in Madhyasth Darshan; several further categories Advaita requires have no Madhyasth counterpart. Surface parallels should not obscure the fork: Advaita is world-subordinating non-dualism; Madhyasth Darshan is relational realism affirming eternal distinct *jeevan* and perpetual *jagat*.

5.7.1 Brahman and *Satta*

Both Brahman and Omnipresence (*satta*) are formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming, timeless, and actionless — the ontological ground of everything. Advaita's Brahman is the *sole* absolute reality (*paramartha*), making the world dependent appearance (*mithya*). Madhyasth Darshan's *Satta* coexists with nature (*prakriti*); both are real. Brahman is awareness itself (*chit*); *Satta* is actionless energy (*kriya-shunya urja*) — the condition of intelligibility — while active sentience (*chaitanya*) belongs exclusively to the *jeevan* unit (§1.13).

5.7.2 *Atman*, *Paramatman*, and *Jeevan*

Both traditions point to the true, immortal, non-material reality of the self. Within the five-fold structure of *jeevan*, *Atma* names the innermost core of realisation. Advaita holds that the true Self (*Atman*) is exactly identical to the single, universal Supreme Self (*Paramatman*). Madhyasth Darshan denies a single universal self; *jeevan* units are permanently distinct, multiple, and active.

Both traditions also use five-layer (*kosha*) language from the Upanishads — Advaita's Taittiriya stack (*annamaya* through *anandamaya*), Madhyasth Darshan's *kosha* and plane exposition (*pran kosha*, *vigyanmaya*, etc.; MVD, pp. 49–50; §§1.7, 1.9). That overlap is terminological, not ontological. Madhyasth Darshan carries two five-fold structures that do not match Advaita's sheaths one-to-one: five inseparable faculties within *jeevan* (*mun*, *vritti*, *chitta*, *buddhi*, *atma*) and developmental planes (animal and deluded humans at four koshas; awakened humans at five including *vigyanmaya*). Advaita peels sheaths away to reveal the Self beneath (VC, vv. 210, 639); Madhyasth Darshan affirms layered human equipment to be harmonised in awakened living. Listing koshas among structural analogues would overstate the parallel.

5.7.3 *Jiva* and deluded *Jeevan*

Jivatman (*jiva*) and deluded *jeevan* (*bhramit jeevan*) both name the individual embodied self experiencing the world, bound by ignorance and body-identification, seeking liberation or resolution. In Advaita, the *jivatman–Paramatman* duality is maintained only at *vyavahara* through conditioning (*upadhis*); upon liberation the duality is seen to have been false — what remains is Brahman alone (CU 6.8.7; BS 1.1.2 with Śaṅkara's bhāṣya; VC, v. 244). For Madhyasth Darshan, individuality is ontologically real and eternal; realisation (*jagriti*) resolves delusion but preserves the active, distinct individuality of the *jeevan*.

5.7.4 *Jagat*, name-form, and units

Jagat / nama-roopa and nature / units (*prakriti* / *ikai*) both point to the physical universe of change, bodies, name, and form. In Advaita, the Jagat is ultimately *mithya* and sublated at the highest realisation. In Madhyasth Darshan, the world of units is *satat* (perpetual) and eternally real.

5.7.5 Categories Advaita needs that Madhyasth Darshan rejects

Several central Advaita categories have no Madhyasth equivalent because co-existentialism explicitly rejects them.

Advaita's Maya is the cosmic power that conceals Brahman (*avarana*) and projects the illusion of the world (*vikshepa*). Madhyasth Darshan has no cosmic power or substance of illusion. Ignorance (*agnyan* / *bhrama*) is the temporary cognitive absence of understanding — lack of awakening — resolved through study and education, not a force projecting unreality.

In Advaita, the world is superimposed (*adhyasa*) on Brahman like a snake on a rope (BS 2.1.14 with Śaṅkara's bhāṣya; VC, v. 20). Madhyasth Darshan has no ontological superimposition. The relationship between units and *Satta* is saturation (*samprikt*) — real, mutual, non-reductive co-location (§1.2; SB, pp. 57, 62, 69) — not projection or false attribution. Do not confuse this with Madhyasth Darshan's homonym *adhyasa* in the animal order — species-traditional inertial-impression from gestation (§1.5; SB, pp. 62–63) — which names conduct-pattern inheritance.

Advaita's mithya (*sad-asad-anirvacaniya* — neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing) describes the world's dependent appearance (CU 6.2.1–6.2.2 with Śaṅkara's bhāṣya; VC, v. 251; §§2.3–2.4). Madhyasth Darshan rejects any intermediate ontological status: everything that exists is real, perpetual, and indestructible.

In Advaita, Ishvara is Brahman associated with *Maya* — operative cause of name-form manifestation, sublated at *paramartha* (VC, v. 244), not a personal creator *ex nihilo*. Madhyasth Darshan rejects Ishvara in this sense — a cosmic governor who plans, acts as efficient cause, or dispenses grace. That is not rejection of transcendence altogether: MVD's ninth Reality set includes "God is omnipresent, deities are many" (proposition 5; §1.14) — *God* names actionless Omnipresence (*satta*), while deities are many denies elevating personal deities to ultimate status. Orderliness (*vyavastha*) is self-regulation (*swatah-saspurt*) inherent in the co-existing orders (§1.11); *Satta* remains actionless (*kriya-shunya*).

Advaita seeks kaivalya — recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman (*jiva-brahma-aikya*), in which the illusion of separate individuality is dispelled (*tat tvam asi*, CU 6.8.7; BS 1.1.2; VC, vv. 244, 574). Madhyasth Darshan holds that individual *jeevan* units remain eternally distinct; the ultimate goal is awakened coexistence (*jagriti*) — active *jeevan* in harmonious relationships (*sambandh*) with other humans and the ecological orders.

While surface-level analogues exist, the core ontological commitments are ultimately irreconcilable. A true one-to-one mapping is impossible without distorting the foundational claims of either system.

6. Critical Review

6.1 Internal coherence of the Madhyasth Darshan position

Judged on its own definitions — not as proof against rivals — the ontology hangs together. Coexistence, real units, and beginninglessness form one picture without separate doctrines for each question (§5.2 summarizes the cross-tradition contrast; §5.3 develops it in prose). "Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual" preserves the reality of nature, society, relationship, and ethical responsibility rather than sublating the world. Consciousness, value, and selfhood are not treated as mere byproducts of body-chemistry.

If existence is coexistence, human fulfilment must be evidenced as coexistence in behaviour, not merely believed. "Nothing existent is annihilated" gives internal coherence to *vastu* persisting through *roop*-change, bodily death as configuration-shift, and development within beginningless coexistence — though post-death continuity of *this jeevan* is a further metaphysical commitment, not a theorem of quantity conservation alone (§1.14, §6.2.3).

These are strengths within the system's premises. They do not by themselves establish those premises against Advaita or physicalism (see §6.2–§6.4).

6.2 Open problems for Madhyasth Darshan

The items below are numbered 6.2.1–6.2.6 for cross-reference. They group under internal coherence, evidence and science, and comparative philosophy.

6.2.1 Emergence of sentience and latency

Madhyasth Darshan holds that an insentient atom, through development, reaches constitutional completeness and becomes sentient *jeevan* (SB, pp. 55, 59). That account uses threshold grammar — a quantitative stability producing a qualitative level of active sentience — which can sound like strong emergence. The darshan also borrows Strawson's anti-emergence principle against physicalism (§3.3). Its resolution is latency: as sketched in §1.6, the Saturation-Reflector Model states how ever-present *gyan* in *satta* reaches active sentience (*chaitanya*) at constitutional completeness without strong emergence from dead matter (§§1.2, 1.7, 1.6) — actualised, not created from nothing (SB, p. 59).

Madhyasth Darshan does not solve the hard problem of consciousness in the physicalist's sense. Sentience is eternally present in coexistence and actualised at constitutional completeness rather than produced from non-experience; the Saturation-Reflector Model is the darshan's central statement of that reading — but it relocates the problem rather than discharging it. Instead of asking why experience arises from wholly non-experiential matter, the system now owes two further questions: (a) why a constitutionally stable atom-configuration channels ever-present *gyan* into active *chaitanya* rather than remaining at the orderliness tier only (selection), and (b) what makes *satta* as *gyan* the experiential ground at all (grounding). Latency converts an emergence problem into a selection problem and a grounding problem; neither is settled here. Against physicalism's gap-only framing, MD also offers a positive account of qualitative felt life: the four *jeevan* values — happiness, peace, contentment, and bliss — as real harmonies within the sentient unit (§1.8), not reducible to brain function alone on the darshan's reading.

In analytical prose the study uses mediating configuration for the stable atom-structure at constitutional completeness; the source texts call it a reflector (*pratibimba* register in SB's saturation language — SB's term). The English word is retained where the texts use it; it should not be read as optical bounce.

Textual basis for latency

SB p. 59: all atom types, including constitutionally complete ones, are "eternally present through the natural law of coexistence." Sentience is not created at completeness; it is actualised. SB p. 55: at completeness, particle count is fixed; change is qualitative without quantitative addition — not the arrival of a new experiential ingredient from non-experience.

Selectivity: why only *gathanpurna parmanu*?

Satta is all-pervasive; every unit is saturated. Pervasiveness does not entail universal active sentience. Saturation provisions inherent orderliness and energy in all units (SB, pp. 57, 69; §1.2); insentient units exhibit radiance and projection only. Active *chaitanya* appears when a constitutionally stable configuration — fixed particle count, self-maintaining completeness, inexhaustible force at the sentient threshold (SB, pp. 55, 59) — acts as the mediating configuration through which ever-present *gyan* reaches the knowing mode.

The texts tie selectivity to constitutional stability — functional indivisibility and qualitative change without further quantitative addition — not to integration (IIT's Φ), metabolic closure alone (autopoiesis), or mere compositional size. The nucleus–orbit structure of *jeevan* (§1.7) makes that stability concrete: one constitutionally complete atom with *atma* as nucleus and faculties as orbital particles, not an aggregate of micro-minds. The principled reason, within the darshan, is developmental: sentience is the evidence of constitutional completeness at the atomic threshold of Development Progression through the physicochemical complex (MVD, p. 76; SB, p. 59), not an independent property bolted onto matter. That is textually grounded but not independently defended against rivals who tie consciousness to information integration, biological self-production, or neural dynamics. A skeptical reader can accept saturation and still ask why particle-count stability is the sentience-relevant threshold rather than some other structural invariant. Comparative threshold accounts are tabulated below; what Madhyasth Darshan adds is latency in *satta*, not a third-person metric.

Answering the physicalist "emergence" objection

Digestion, weak emergence, IIT, and self-models share threshold grammar with *gathanpurnata* — potential organised one way, a qualitative level appears at a structural condition. Latency-at-a-threshold is structurally close to what IIT and weak emergence do; the disanalogy is what the threshold actualises:

Rival account	What the threshold does	Experiential ground
Digestion / weak emergence	New function from chemistry	None; organisation only
Self-model / predictive processing	Regulative model from neural dynamics	None; representation only
IIT	Consciousness from integrated information (Φ)	Experience tied to information structure

Rival account	What the threshold does	Experiential ground
Saturation-Reflector (MD)	Active *chaitanya* from ever-present *gyan* in *satta*	Coexistential intelligibility-ground; latency

Madhyasth Darshan therefore does not treat sentience as strong emergence from dead matter. It treats sentience as latency actualised through a mediating configuration — consistent with Strawson's anti-emergence principle (§3.3) while restricting active sentience to constitutionally complete atoms, not every particle. Strawson's combination problem (§3.3) presses panpsychism; Madhyasth Darshan's reply is that *jeevan* is already one constitutionally complete unit, not an assembly of micro-minds — but that reply still leaves the threshold itself as the locus of unresolved selection and grounding.

Madhyasth Darshan and panpsychism share a deeper grounding commitment: experientiality — here as *gyan* / intelligibility-ground in *satta* — is primitive, not derived from wholly non-experiential matter. They differ in distribution: not every particle is a subject; only *gathanpurna parmanu* actualises active *chaitanya*. The combination-problem escape in §3.3 is therefore scope-relative, not a discharge of the grounding posit. A physicalist can still read latency as panpsychism with selective actualization — proto-experience in *satta* rather than in particles, but experientiality-as-fundamental nonetheless.

Self-model and predictive-processing theories explain hierarchical regulation; they do not by themselves refute latency, because latency does not deny embodied regulation — it locates the sentient unit that works through the body.

What remains open

The model is a metaphysical framework, not a detailed physical mechanism. It does not answer physicalism's demand for third-person public evidence (§6.4.2), nor does it reconcile the claimed liberation from molecular- and weight-bondage at *gathanpurnata* (§1.6.1) with modern particle physics — where composite bound states decay and mass is not something one simply opts out of (§6.2.3). The hard problem is asserted away only in the weak sense that latency denies experience-from-nothing; it is not solved in the strong sense until selection and grounding are independently motivated and the Nagarjuna challenge (§6.2.2) is answered. Formalizing that reading within the law of coexistence — and defending it against Nagarjuna's *svabhava* critique — is the most promising route for later rigorous work.

6.2.2 Mutual dependence and the Nagarjuna challenge

Madhyasth Darshan holds saturation as mutual dependence for manifestation (§1.2; SB, p. 62; MVD, p. 40): without unit-activity, uniform energy at the ground is unmanifest; without saturation, there is no basic impulsion. Nagarjuna's *svabhava* critique — in the *Mulamadhyamakakarika* — asks whether what exists only through mutual dependence can exist from its own side at all. That is among the gravest philosophical threats to coexistential realism: beginningless co-dependence can still read as emptiness of intrinsic nature.

The texts' implicit reply — never framed as anti-Buddhist — rests on §1.1. *Satta* and units are co-eternally inseparable; separation of unit from saturated fullness "never happens" (SB, p. 70), and no unit is "ever separated from Omnipresence" (SB, p. 57; JV, p. 18). Omnipresence has no place absent (SB, pp. 48, 62, 69), while units are bounded wholes within that field — definite distance in mutuality regulated in formless existence (SB, pp. 57, 59, 79) — with lawful provision for mutual recognition (SB, pp. 50, 57, 62). Dependence is for revelation, not for ontological absence of either pole (MVD, p. 40; MVD, p. 13 on *jagat satat* and plural *jeevan*). The ground is *sthitipurn* and asymmetrically sustaining; nature saturated in it is *sthitishil* (§1.1). Madhyasth Darshan's *svabhav* names order-specific essential nature in mutuality, not Buddhist *svabhava* (Appendix). Anatta attacks immortal *jeevan* on a separate flank (§5.5).

This clarifies what coexistence claims against misreadings — isolated substances entering relation, or bare flux with no final units — but does not refute Nagarjuna. The primary text nowhere engages emptiness or dependent origination; it asserts indestructible units that can never be annihilated (SB, p. 57), an eternalist (*sasvatavada*) ontology — the very extreme Madhyamaka's middle way rejects. So Madhyasth Darshan answers the *svabhava* critique by asserting a rival position, not by defeating it on its own terms: a Madhyamaka reader can still hold that bounded co-eternal wholes are conventionally real yet empty at paramartha, while MD assigns *jagat satat* and immortal *jeevan* final weight.

Pressure	Madhyasth Darshan implicit answer	Still open
Saturation / boundaries	Co-eternal inseparability; bounded wholes in omnipresence; asymmetric sustaining vs active roles	Whether co-eternal structure escapes *svabhava* emptiness at final truth
Unit signature	Order-specific *svabhav* in mutuality, not isolated substance	Bridge to Buddhist *svabhava* for anglophone readers
Jeevan / *anatta*	Constitutionally immortal sentient atom (§§1.7, 1.6)	Anatta denies what MD asserts without shared proof
Conservation	*Vastu* conserved through *roop*-change (§1.14)	Persistence inference vs physics (§6.2.3)

Formal work on the law of coexistence (§6.2.1) must show that dependence-for-manifestation and co-eternal co-presence are principled — not merely verbal. Until then, Nagarjuna's challenge stays central among open problems; the reply remains open, not settled.

6.2.3 Mereology, identity, conservation inference, and rebirth

Category error first: JV p. 20 is the system's most empirically exposed inference — post-death survival and re-association of *jeevan* from "nothing is annihilated." From the standpoint of modern science, this inference conflates conservation of quantity with conservation of structure (or entity): physics conserves mass-energy and charge, but not specific configurations or functional identities. Thermodynamic and field-theoretic conservation alone do not guarantee the immortality of a structured unit like *jeevan* unless *gathanpurnata* is already assumed as a separate metaphysical axiom. §1.14 separates coexistence conservation from *jeevan* persistence and rebirth; the friction with particle physics is whether a particular composite configuration — once constitutionally complete — is immune to decay or decomposition, when composite bound states in physics are not absolutely indestructible. That is the weakest inferential link for post-death survival and transmigration and should be weighed accordingly.

Madhyasth Darshan's own reply to the composite-decay worry is stated in §1.6.1: at constitutional completeness the atom is liberated from molecular-bondage and weight-bondage (MVD, p. 91; SB, p. 114). The sentient unit is therefore not modeled as an ordinary molecular bound state subject to the same decay grammar. The sharpest test from physics is not whether MD forgot composite instability, but whether weight-bondage exit is coherent with mass, energy, and gravitational coupling in public science — a friction that belongs in open problems regardless of how the texts answer mereology.

The *gathanpurna parmanu* at issue is not an elementary particle in the sense of modern physics. MVD treats every atom as a composite: its kind, state, and measure are fixed by the number of particles in its nucleus and its orbiting dependent particles (MVD, p. 42); constitutional completeness is reached when the required number of such particles is integrated into a stable compound configuration (SB, pp. 55, 59; §1.6). Madhyasth Darshan reads *jeevan*'s "indivisibility" as functional — a self-maintaining constitution whose nucleus–orbit structure is one integrated sentient atom (§1.7) — not as the claim that *jeevan* has no parts. Identity is continuity of that constitution across death and re-association (§§1.7–1.8).

6.2.4 *Jeevan*–body interaction

If *jeevan* is a constitutionally complete atom that drives the body, physicalist readers face an interaction problem as old as Descartes — the Cartesian gap between a weightless sentient unit and a molecular nervous system. Either *jeevan* exerts physical force on neural and muscular tissue — in which case the interaction should be measurable in principle, and constitutional completeness should be operationalizable, contradicting §6.2.5 — or it does not exert physical force, in which case "drives" must name a non-mechanical mode of influence that the texts have not fully specified in modern vocabulary. Readers trained in physics will press a sharper thermodynamic question: if *jeevan* is free of molecular bondage and weight-bondage (§6.2.3), how can it steer the brain without injecting energy and violating conservation? MD also restricts full knowledge-order awakening to the human joint form (§1.13; MVD, p. 115), so the interaction question is not posed for every sentient plane alike.

What the primary texts do say. Humans are a joint form of *jeevan* and body; the body is medium and instrument, not the sentient self (§1.13; MVD p. 13). MVD's four-level causal hierarchy places *atma* within *jeevan* as causal level — gross body, subtle atoms, causal *atma*, supreme cause *satta* (MVD, pp. 288–289) — so intention is not modeled as a separate substance pushing neurons from outside. MVD p. 115 describes vibrational motion on the brain from the cognitive organs leading to knowledge-unfolding (§1.13) — a pathway description within the human as joint form, not a proof of physical causal closure.

State and order versus kinetic energy. On the reading the texts most strongly suggest, *jeevan* 's "driving" is not modeled as a ghostly piston adding joules to neural tissue from outside a closed thermodynamic system. The human is already a joint form (§1.13): effort–motion–result is one inseparable activity in which body and *jeevan* co-participate (§1.6). MVD's vibrational motion on the brain from the cognitive organs (p. 115) describes motion within that joint pathway — the ordering of activity through which *gyan udghatan* unfolds in awakened humans (*Knowledge, Knower, and Known* §1.1) — not an external force vector registered on a calorimeter. *Jeevan* carries inherent energy as saturated orderliness (§1.2); inward regulation channels faculty activity toward awakening (MVD, p. 77), and at constitutional completeness the sentient unit is read as liberated from weight-bondage (§6.2.3). In comparative vocabulary helpful to physicist readers — not as MD's own English labels — the link is closer to transmission of state, order, and informational structure (which faculty is active, how resolve and desire are coordinated, whether inward regulation succeeds) than to supply of macroscopic kinetic energy from a separate substance. Resonance or constraint language captures part of the picture: the body remains the medium; *jeevan* orients the joint form's activity without being modeled as a second motor doing work on the first. That reading spares the crude Cartesian picture of an immaterial object pushing neurons, and it aligns with why the four-level hierarchy treats *atma* as causal level within the joint form rather than as a Cartesian ego adjacent to the pineal gland. It does not by itself answer Kim-style causal closure: coordinating order inside a joint system may still require that every physical state transition have a sufficient physical cause, and whether MD's joint-causation satisfies that constraint remains unsettled below.

What the primary texts do not settle. Whether *jeevan*'s "driving" violates physical causal closure or names non-mechanical influence within the effort–motion–result activity already attributed to the human as joint form. Even if the driving is read as state and order transmission rather than kinetic-energy injection — sparing the thermodynamic violation a naive Cartesian reading would imply — Kim-style closure remains open: the texts commit neither to measurable extra physical force nor to epiphenomenal accompaniment. The system appears to take the non-Cartesian horn in spirit — hierarchical unit-causation within coexistence — but whether that horn satisfies modern physics remains open in the primary sources, not only in the comparative account here.

Full treatment — including whether joint-form order-causation can be stated consistently with closed physics, and how vibrational pathways relate to neural dynamics — belongs in the planned *Philosophy-Of-Mind-And-Jeevan* study.

6.2.5 Evidence standard and operationalization

Constitutional completeness is central to the ontology but not presently measurable in physics or chemistry. Realisation and behaviour are cited; science requires public testability. What would count as evidence for *jeevan* beyond the hard-problem explanatory gap? §6.4.2

addresses this. An explanatory gap in the hard problem is not by itself an existence proof for *jeevan*; physicalists treat it as philosophically non-decisive while Madhyasth Darshan reads it as ontological incompleteness in matter-only accounts (§3.2, §6.2.1). Comparisons with physics use consonant with, parallel to, or in tension with — not "supported by" unless the evidence warrants it; conceptual resonance with beginningless cosmological models is not proof of perpetual nature (*satat*) (§4.3). Claims about individual immortality and constitutional completeness remain distinct metaphysical assertions beyond what current science validates. Comparative work must also not collapse *gyan* as *satta* into Advaita's *chit* (Brahman as awareness itself) — a misreading the English translation's "Consciousness" label encourages (Editorial Notes).

6.2.6 Fixed order vs evolutionary contingency

Madhyasth Darshan's *niyati-kram* (§1.5) treats order emergence as definite and guaranteed — pranic from material, animal from pranic, knowledge from animal — not merely as one possible developmental story among others. Mainstream evolutionary biology, by contrast, explains the diversity and fit of organisms through contingent historical processes: heritable variation, differential reproduction, and environmental filtering (§4.6). The same four orders can therefore be read in two readings — as MD's stable plateaus with fixed enrichment on Earth, or as science's historically produced lineages and ecological networks.

What would count as evidence for guaranteed order emergence rather than oriented-but-contingent development remains unsettled. A reconciliation that preserves *niyati-kram* without reducing it to metaphor would need to show how definite order progression and evolutionary contingency are both true under coexistence — or to state clearly which reading is ontological and which empirical. Until that is developed, the fixed-order claim is a distinctive MD commitment in direct tension with §4.6's evolutionary picture, not a theorem established by comparative argument alone.

6.3 Strengths and Limits of Advaita

Advaita has a powerful answer to non-being (existence cannot arise from non-existence, CU 6.2.2) and a rigorous first-person method — DDV's seer-seen discrimination and MU's three-state analysis (§§2.1–2.6). Its ontology is also parsimonious: one partless Brahman, without a second ground, without plural immortal substances, without a separate cosmic power of illusion standing alongside the absolute. Against Madhyasth Darshan's coexistence of *satta*, countless *ikai*, definite *sambandh*, and latency at *gathanpurnata*, Advaita compresses existence into a single subject whose empirical multiplicity is finally sublated.

Two further limits belong alongside world-subordination, developed in §§5.6–5.7. On individuality, liberation in Advaita is *jiva-brahma-aikya* — separate *jivatman* is *upadhi*-conditioned appearance dispelled at *paramartha* (§§2.5, 5.3.3). Madhyasth Darshan holds many constitutionally complete, immortal *jeevan* units that remain distinct after awakening; relational realism and post-death continuity (§§1.7–1.8) require that individuality, not only robust *vyavahara*. On structural vocabulary, Advaita's *Maya*, *adhyasa*, *mithya*, and Brahman as *chit* (awareness itself) do not map onto Madhyasth Darshan's saturation, *jagat satat*, and *gyan* as intelligibility-ground without active knowing in *satta* (§§1.13, 5.6, 5.7.5). Those are not minor terminological gaps; they mark where the two systems part on what finally exists.

Its limit, from the Madhyasth perspective, is that making the world *mithya* at *paramartha* makes it harder to ground the final ontological weight of relationships, nature, society, and conduct — even though *vyavahara* is robust, shared, and law-governed (§2.3). Nagraj's native objection, framed against the Vedanta he inherited, presses this point from origination:

> **"According to Vedanta knowledge, only Brahma is the truth, and this world is an illusion ('Brahma satya, jagat mithya'). However, jeeva and jagat are said to have originated from Brahma."**
> *- MVD, The Alternative*
>
> **"How can the jeeva and jagat, which originated from the Truth, Knowledge, and Infinite Brahma, be an illusion?"**
> *- MVD, The Alternative*

Madhyasth Darshan's counter-slogan — *Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual* (MVD, p. 13; §1.14) — is not mere rhetoric. If *jeeva* and *jagat* arise from Sat-Chit-Ananda Brahman through *satkaryavada*, treating them as finally *mithya* looks internally unstable: the effect would be less real than a cause whose nature is being, consciousness, and bliss. Advaita's reply is the three-tier distinction and *vivartavada*: name-form is dependently real at *vyavahara* and sublated only at *paramartha*; the clay-pot is not nothing, but its separateness from clay is (VC, v. 251; §§2.3–2.4). That reply is coherent within Advaita; Madhyasth Darshan denies that sublation is the last word on the world.

Advaita's fair reply to world-negation — ethics, *loka-sangraha*, and beginningless *vyavahara* — is substantial and is exposited in §2.9; it should not be dismissed in a sentence. The Madhyasth counter-reply is narrower but precise. Beginningless *vyavahara* and robust ethics do not settle final ontological status. *Satat* (*perpetual*) names a world that retains full weight at the highest realisation — relationships, nature, and *mulya* are not ultimately sublated (§5.7). An ontology that makes the world *mithya* at *paramartha* cannot give the world the same final weight coexistence gives it. This is a genuine disagreement about whether *vyavahara*'s robustness suffices for Madhyasth Darshan's standard of world-realness, not a defeat of Advaita on its own terms.

Madhyasth Darshan's exposed point against Advaita's parsimony is the cost of plurality: many immortal *jeevan* units, saturation mutual dependence, and tiered *gyan*/*chaitanya* buy relational realism at the price of ontological complexity Advaita refuses. Whether that cost is justified is part of what §6.2.2 and §5.3.5 leave open; Advaita's cost is world-subordination at the highest truth. Neither system is free of trade-offs.

6.4 Strengths and Limits of Modern Approaches

The subsections below are numbered 6.4.1–6.4.3 for cross-reference. They treat modern strengths and comparative limits, the evidential bar on *jeevan*, and physicalism's strongest developed reply.

6.4.1 Strengths, exposed limits, and partial alliance

Modern approaches are strongest where Madhyasth Darshan is weakest: public evidence, empirical correction, cognitive modelling, precise mechanism. Self-model theory explains many features of embodied selfhood without an eternal *jeevan*; illusionism shows how a naturalist can reinterpret even the apparent obviousness of experience.

On physicalism's exposed limit, the hard problem persists — correlation of brain and experience is not disputed, but why any physical process should have an inside at all remains open (§3.2); consciousness science offers rival threshold programs (IIT, autopoiesis, workspace and higher-order accounts) without consensus or a third-person metric for latency in *satta* (§4.2, §6.2.1). That is not a proof of *jeevan*; it marks where reductive matter-only ontology still owes an account of experience. On partial alliance, scientific realism treats the physical world as mind-independent and law-governed — aligning with Madhyasth Darshan against world-negation at the highest truth (§5.1, §5.3.2) — and QFT conservation of configurations under transformation is structurally consonant with *vastu* persisting through *roop*-change, though fields are not *satta* and quantity conservation is not entity persistence (§4.4, §6.2.3). On strengths against immortal *jeevan*, physicalism asserts causal closure — no non-physical partner injecting force into neural dynamics without violating conservation (§3.1) — and medicine operationalizes personal end at brain death when whole-brain function fails irreversibly (§4.1). Those are genuine pressures on post-death continuity and *jeevan*–body interaction, not mere rhetorical dismissal.

But modern philosophy is not unified. Chalmers and Nagel show experience resists reduction; Strawson shows some physicalists move toward panpsychism. It is inaccurate to say "modern philosophy has proved the self is only the brain." What modern philosophy has established is a high evidential bar: an explanatory gap is not an existence proof for *jeevan*.

6.4.2 The evidential bar and trade-offs

Public science would require at minimum: (a) operational criteria for constitutional completeness independent of the philosophy; (b) reproducible markers distinguishing *jeevan*-mediated from brain-only activity; (c) independent evidence for post-death continuity of a sentient unit. Until then, Madhyasth Darshan's claims about immortal *jeevan* remain metaphysical assertions compatible with coexistence conservation but not validated by current science — while the hard problem shows physicalism's own exposed point (§3.2). The three traditions also use partially incommensurable criteria of knowing (§5.3.5); public science cannot by itself settle what conduct-evidence or realisation-based study would count as proof.

Madhyasth Darshan's exposed point against physicalism's parsimony is the cost of excluding immortal sentient units, latency in *satta*, and conduct-evidence from what public science currently measures. Whether that cost is justified is part of what §6.2.1 leaves open; physicalism's cost is leaving first-person realisation and individual survival outside third-person confirmation unless new criteria appear. Neither system is free of trade-offs.

6.4.3 Physicalism's strongest reply: predictive processing

Physicalism's most developed recent reply to ontology-of-self challenges is predictive processing and active inference — exposited in §4.1 with the scientific evidence standard in §4.7. That reply deserves the same seriousness as Advaita's *loka-sangraha* defence in §6.3: it meets Madhyasth Darshan partway on embodiment, circular causation, and the reality of regulation in lived experience, and it is a harder opponent than bare eliminativism because it does not treat first-person structure as a mistake to explain away.

The Madhyasth counter-reply is narrower. Predictive models explain how a body self-regulates and represents its situation; they do not settle whether the regulator is only neural tissue or a distinct constitutionally complete unit working through the brain. Latency holds that sentience is actualised from coexistential ground at *gathanpurnata*, not generated as a new experiential ingredient from dead matter (§6.2.1). Until public criteria distinguish those ontologies, the dispute remains at the incommensurability boundary (§5.3.5) — not settled by predictive accuracy alone.

7. Conclusion

Madhyasth Darshan answers the framing questions through a single ontological picture: eternally present coexistence (*saha-astitva*) of formless Omnipresence (*satta*) and countless units (*ikai*), beginningless and neither made from the other. Saturation binds ground to units; *sambandh*, complementarity, and value-fulfilment bind units to one another; complementary units compose into tiered assemblies from particles through societies (§1.10).

What exists does not begin from non-existence (*abhava*); bodies and configurations do, while *vastu* persists through transformation. Time (*kaal*) is the duration of unit-activity, not an independent cosmic container (§1.6.4). Causation is circular and order-specific: *satta* is *mahakaran* — sustaining ground, not efficient trigger — and units work change through effort–motion–result (*shram–gati–parinam*), read in sentient nature toward immortality of result, restfulness of effort, and destination of motion at constitutional, activity, and conduct completeness (§§1.6–1.12). Sentience belongs to the constitutionally complete atom (*gathanpurna parmanu*), actualised from coexistential ground rather than produced from dead matter (§6.2.1).

> **"Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual."**
> *- MVD, p. 13*

That formulation marks what is distinctive in comparative terms, though latency's selection and grounding problems, the conservation-to-immortality inference, and the Madhyamaka/*anatta* challenge remain open (§6.2, §6.2.1).

Against physicalism, Madhyasth Darshan refuses matter-only reduction: consciousness, value, selfhood, and ethical relation are not exhaustively explained as brain-generated epiphenomena, yet the world of units remains fully real for study and responsibility — not a second-class appearance. Against Advaita, it refuses world-negation at the highest level: the perpetual world (*jagat satat*), distinct immortal *jeevan* units, and ontologically real relationships and values (*mulya*) retain final weight; coexistence is not compressed into a single subject whose empirical multiplicity is finally *mithya*.

Against both, it holds a relational realism: Brahma is real, the world is real, and their inseparable presentness is coexistence — with ontology tied to conduct, so that understanding is fulfilled when coexistence becomes clear in one's own seeing and evident in humane living, responsible work, and experiment. The pairwise patterns in §5.1 show where each tradition agrees and diverges on these stakes; the critical review in §6 examines what remains open within and against that position.

Appendix: Quick Glossary

Key terms from §§1–4 are collected here for quick reference. Each term is also defined where it first appears in the exposition.

Terms in §1

Term	Plain meaning
Coexistence (*saha-astitva*)	Reality as the pervasive ground (*satta*) and all units (*ikai*) inseparably present together — beginningless, without creation from nothing.
Satta (Omnipresence)	The formless, all-pervasive, non-transforming ground in which all units are saturated. See Editorial Notes on translation conventions.
Unit (*ikai*)	A countable, bounded entity in nature — insentient (*jada*) or sentient (*chaitanya*).
Saturation (*samprikt*)	The ever-present bond in which each unit is soaked, submerged, and surrounded in Omnipresence; from saturated bounded plurality three endowments follow in every unit — recognition capability for complementarity, activeness, and inherent regulation (§1.2).

Term	Plain meaning
Effort–motion–result (*shram–gati–parinam*)	The inseparable triad of unit-activity powered by saturation, identical to the unit's existence. In the sentient atom, result (*parinam*) seeks the goal of immortality (*amarta*) at constitutional completeness; effort (*shram*) seeks the goal of restfulness (*vishram*) at activity completeness; and motion (*gati*) seeks the goal of destination (*gantavya*) at conduct completeness (SB pp. 58, 71; MVD p. 104).
Immortality of result (*parinam ki amarta*)	The teleological goal of result (*parinam*) at constitutional completeness (T1 / *gathanpurnata*) — permanent stabilisation of the atom's physical structure (§1.6).
Restfulness of effort (*shram ka vishram*)	The teleological goal of effort (*shram*) at activity completeness (T2 / *kriyapurnata*) — internal cognitive seeking resolves into realisation and *samadhan*; not relational ease in §1.3 (§1.6).
Destination of motion (*gati ka gantavya*)	The teleological goal of motion (*gati*) at conduct completeness (T3 / *vyavaharpurnata*) — external behavioural participation aligned with universal orderliness (§1.6).
The four orders (*chaar avastha*)	Material, bio/pranic, animal, and knowledge/human — real developmental plateaus in nature.
Relationship (*sambandh*)	Definite mutuality with expectations predetermined toward completeness (MVD p. 62).
Law (ontological)	Orderliness and regulation read from saturation — universal across all four orders; not statutory command.
Jeevan	The sentient self: a constitutionally complete, immortal unit — *atma* as nucleus, *buddhi–mun* as orbital structure — that works through the body (§1.7).
Constitutional completeness (*gathanpurnata*)	When a developed atom integrates its required particles and crosses irreversibly into sentient *jeevan* (Transition 1, T1).
Existential progression (*niyati-kram*)	Fixed macro sequence in nature: pranic order from material, animal from pranic, knowledge/human from animal — not contingent reordering of plateaus (§1.9).
Way of existence (*niyati-vidhi*)	Definiteness in the conduct of each of the four orders; paired with *niyati-kram* (order emergence ↔ order conduct; §1.11).
Development progression (*vikas-kram*)	Atomic-level movement through the physicochemical complex until an atom reaches constitutional completeness and sentient *jeevan* appears (§1.9).

Term	Plain meaning
Awakening progression (*jagriti-kram*)	Sentient-level movement within constitutionally complete *jeevan* toward fuller activity and conduct (§1.9).
Jeevan values (*sukh*, *shanti*, *santosh*, *anand*)	Four felt harmonies within *jeevan* — happiness, peace, contentment, bliss — organised through faculty pairs (§1.8).
Utility value (*upyogita*)	Usefulness of natural abundance made available through labour; definite and constant across time (JV p. 123).
Art value (*kala*)	Aesthetic enhancement of utility — beautification along with usefulness (MVD p. 324).
Human values	Values of humane living grasped through coexistence understanding and humane conduct (JV pp. 44, 139); one of six value kinds (§1.4).
Established values	Relationship values — care, trust, affection, and the like — that flow when relationships are recognised (JV pp. 108, 138; §1.4).
Expression values	Right-use of body, mind, and wealth in the social order; *civic values* in Gupta's English (MVD p. 306; §1.4).
Knowledge sense (four)	Four meanings of *gyan* / knowledge the texts must not conflate — ontological given, intelligibility-ground in *satta*, telos of fulfilled relationships, and unfolding through awakened *jeevan* (§1.13).
Evaluative domain	Conduct, thought, or realisation — the three humane perspectives discipline distinct domains (§1.12).
Sentient mode	How effort–motion–result maps once constitutional completeness is reached — distinct from insentient unit-activity (§1.6).

Further terms — planes, justice, prosperity — are defined where they first appear in §1.

Terms in §2

Term	Plain meaning
Brahman	The sole absolute reality — being, consciousness, bliss (*sat-chit-ananda*), one without a second.
Paramartha	Absolute level of truth; Brahman alone is absolutely real.
Vyavahara	Shared empirical order — bodies, law, ethics, scripture; robust but sublated at highest realisation.

Term	Plain meaning
Pratibhasika	Private apparent error (rope-snake, dream objects); sublated by correction.
Mithya	Dependent appearance — neither absolutely real nor sheer nothing; valid at *vyavahara*, sublated at *paramartha*.
Maya	Cosmic power of concealment (*avarana*) and projection (*vikshepa*); Ishvara's superimposition on Brahman.
Avidya	Individual ignorance — the jiva's superimposition of body-mind on the Self.
Adhyasa	Superimposition — attributing what belongs to one level to another (snake on rope).
Satkaryavada	The effect pre-exists in the cause (clay already in the pot).
Vivartavada	Apparent transformation — Brahman does not change; name-form is projected.
Upadhi	Limiting adjunct conditioning the Self (body, mind, sheaths).
Turiya	The "fourth" — witness-consciousness beyond waking, dream, and deep sleep.
Sakshin	Witness — the seer that is never itself an object of perception.
Moksha	Liberation — recognition of pre-existing identity with Brahman, not merger of a real individual.

Terms in §3

Term	Plain meaning
Physicalism	The view that every real, concrete phenomenon is physical — minds and selves are processes or organisations of physical systems.
Causal closure	Every physical event has a sufficient physical cause; no non-physical entity injects energy or intention into the physical order (Kim 2005).
Hard problem	Why and how physical processes give rise to subjective experience — the "something it is like" (Chalmers 1995; Nagel 1974).
Panpsychism	Experience is fundamental or ubiquitous in nature; wholly non-experiential matter cannot produce experience (Strawson 2006).
Combination problem	If micro-experientiality is primitive, how do micro-subjects combine into one unified macro-subject?
Illusionism	Phenomenal consciousness as usually conceived is a misdescription; only access-consciousness and functional states exist (Frankish 2016).

Term	Plain meaning
Personal identity	What makes a person the same individual over time — psychological continuity (Locke), reductionism (Parfit), or substance (soul, monad).
Scientific realism	The physical world exists mind-independently and is the proper object of public inquiry.
Neutral monism	Mind and matter are composed of a common neutral stuff, neither mental nor material in isolation (Russell 1921; Mach 1914).
Samadhanatmak bhautikvad	Resolution Centred Materialism — MD's reframing of materialism: real matter saturated in Omnipresence, not consciousness-from-matter or matter-only reduction (SB).

Terms in §4

Term	Plain meaning
Self-model	The brain's internal representation of the organism as a unified subject — not an immortal unit but a regulative construct (Metzinger 2003).
Predictive processing / active inference	The brain as a hierarchical generative model minimizing prediction error; selfhood as functionally real control structure (Friston 2010; Clark 2016).
Integrated information (Φ)	IIT's measure of how much a system's cause–effect structure is irreducible; consciousness tied to a structural threshold (Tononi 2012).
Autopoiesis	Living organisation as a self-producing network maintaining its boundary through metabolism (Maturana and Varela 1980).
ΛCDM	Standard cosmological model: cold dark matter plus dark energy; hot big bang ~13.8 billion years ago.
Quantum field	In QFT, what persists are fields; particles are localized excitations, not tiny enduring substances (Weinberg 1995).
Brain death	Operational criterion for end of personhood in medicine — irreversible loss of whole-brain function.
Entropy	Thermodynamic tendency toward disorder in closed systems; distinct from MD's orderliness (*vyavastha*) at every order.
Natural selection	Differential reproduction of heritable traits; mainstream mechanism for biological adaptation and cooperation.

Editorial Notes

Translation and editorial conventions (*satta*)

The source texts' primary English term for the all-pervasive, formless reality (*satta*) is Omnipotence; *vyapak* ("all-pervasive") is rendered "Omnipresence" in the English translation. The English translation alternates Omnipotence and Omnipresence for the same *satta*; Hindi *satta* is the constant behind both. To avoid the theistic connotations of "Omnipotence," the study uses "Omnipresence" as its running English term in analytical prose. Block quotes preserve whichever word the translation prints. Where Hindi *shunya* appears, the translation renders it Space — void/emptiness (actionless, formless), not physical *akasha*.

Analytical vocabulary: sense, domain, mode

The source texts reuse words — *gyan*, *nyaya*, law — at more than one level of meaning. Conflating those levels is a common source of misreading. This study uses sense for distinct meanings of knowledge terms (§1.13); domain for conduct, thought, and realisation — and for regulation, justice, and statute — in §1.12; and mode or level where the darshan marks a qualitative threshold (sentience, emergence). Register is reserved for ordinary English (*registers as happiness*, *activity registers on another*) and for quoted source usage — not as a standalone analytical label.

"Consciousness" in SB p. 48

The English translation lists several names for the pervasive reality (*Satta* / *Vyapak*): Uniform Energy, Space (*shunya*), Knowledge (*gyan*), Consciousness, Omnipresence, Eternity, God, and Absolute Energy. In SB p. 48, the parenthetical "(consciousness)" labels the all-pervasive reality, not a personal knowing mind. Sentience as the activity of a knower (*chaitanya*) is the status of *jeevan* (the sentient unit), not of Omnipresence (*satta*) itself. This distinction is essential; the comparative risk of collapsing *satta*-as-*gyan* into Advaita's *chit* is addressed in §1.13 and §6.2.5.

Naming tensions for *satta*

The source gives *satta* multiple English names. Several generate internal tensions if treated as interchangeable:

Name	Tension
Knowledge / Consciousness	Implies cognition — yet *satta* is denied as knower (§1.13).
Space / *Shunya*	Void/emptiness vs. fullness of energy; *shunya* is rendered "Space" in the English translation, not physical *akasha*.

Name	Tension
God	Personhood vs. actionless, non-willing *satta*.
Absolute Energy	Dynamism vs. *kriya-shunya* (actionless).
Uniform Energy, Eternity	Listed alongside the names above; no single English label captures all aspects.

The source does not fully settle how these names cohere as one reality.

Madhyasth Darshan *svabhav* and Buddhist *svabhava*

Anglophone readers trained on Madhyamaka will hear Madhyasth Darshan's essential nature (*svabhav*) and hear Buddhist intrinsic existence (*svabhava*) — the same English stem, different technical terms. That homonym does real damage: "inherent energy," "essential nature," and "indestructible unit" can sound like precisely the intrinsic status Nagarjuna targets (§6.2.2).

In Madhyasth Darshan, *svabhav* names order-specific essential nature — how a unit's properties participate in mutuality and maintain balance among the four orders (§1.3). In Madhyamaka, *svabhava* names existence from its own side, incompatible with dependent origination. Read the essential-nature table in §1.3 with that distinction in mind; the Madhyamaka engagement belongs in §6.2.2, not in a casual identification of the two terms.

Advaita: *mithya* and *sad-asad-anirvacaniya*

The *mithya* doctrine and Advaita's three-tier framework (*pratibhasika*, *vyavahara*, *paramartha*) are related but distinct tools; §2 keeps them apart. The compound *sad-asad-anirvacaniya* is a post-Shankara systematic term (Vimuktatman, Vivarana school); Shankara uses "neither sat nor asat" language without that compound.

Advaita: *Vivekachudamani* as source

This study cites the *Vivekachudamani* (VC) heavily for accessible verse formulations of discrimination, ethics, and liberation. VC is a devotional *prakriya* (method) text traditionally attributed to Shankara; modern scholarship treats that authorship as uncertain. The Upanishads, *Mandukya*, and DDV supply the exegetical core; VC supplies pedagogical compression. Claims tied to VC should be read as standard Advaita teaching in that genre, not as a substitute for Brahma Sutra commentary on disputed points.

References

Madhyasth Darshan (definitions)

- **Paribhasha** — Nagraj, A. *Paribhasha Samhita* (Hindi, ed. 2008). English selection of definitions on madhyasth.org. Cited: *niyati-kram* (existential progression) and *niyati-vidhi* (way of existence) (§§1.5, 1.8, 1.10).

Madhyasth Darshan (primary sources)

- **MVD** — Nagraj, A. *Madhyasth Darshan — Co-existentialism*. English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: Realisation Knowledge and Effort–Motion–Result principle (p. 11); Realisation–Behaviour–Experiment evidence chain (p. 12); reciprocal revelation and eternal co-presence of nature in absolute energy (p. 40); mediative Omnipotence, regulated conserved nature, mediative nucleus (p. 26); Omnipresence/Space (pp. 11, 13, 35); nine Reality propositions (pp. 12–13); definite development and awakening, laws inherent to being (p. 5); hungry/overfull atoms, planetary composition, and Earth biological emergence (pp. 8, 13); Postulations: physicochemical nature in development progression; atom as sentient unit (p. 14); Verity chain, orderliness as development and awakening (pp. 14–15); Development and Awakening Progression (pp. 13–14, 27, 87); "Brahma is truth, the world is perpetual" (p. 13); Vedanta origination objection and *jagat satat* counter (*The Alternative*; §6.3); gist of coexistence (p. 5); *vyapak* at all places and times (p. 34); time (*kaal*) as duration of activity (pp. 34, 196, 338); measurement of time through mathematics (p. 195); *jeevan*-cloud and faculties (pp. 83–84); six *drishti*, perspective domain mapping, balanced and unbalanced *vritti*, yathartha visualization (pp. 58, 60–61, 66–67, 71, 126–127); happiness and peace to affection and trust (p. 72); three-stage study path — study, experiment and practice, realisation with evidence (p. 88); observation, examination, and survey (p. 115); *jeevan* values as faculty harmonies — sukh, shanti, santosh, anand (p. 101); relationship vs association, grace, *sadhan*, and *kshamata–yogyata–patrata* (pp. 61–62); mixture vs compound composition (p. 42); insentient vs sentient definition, constitution as recognition–fulfilment, inward regulation of *jeevan* energies (p. 77); *atma* as mediative regulator of faculties (p. 277); ascending/frustration and order-specific orbit activity (p. 79); action-dependence of animals (p. 69); family/community assembly (p. 55); seed and *rachna vidhi* (pp. 92–93); *patrata–drishti–darshan* and capacity–ability–receptivity for worldview (pp. 134, 142, 302); moral development tiers (p. 160); knowledge unfolding by awakened humans (p. 115); *sanskar* definition (p. 90); unit signature, *svabhav*, and innateness (*dharma*) in mutuality (p. 112); four-level causal hierarchy and mortal/immortal/eternal *dharma*s (p. 288); order-specific cyclical manifestation and knowledge unfolding through *jeevan*/thoughts (p. 289); reflection–projection cycle (pp. 290–291); effort–motion–result in *jeevan* (p. 78); *atma* as nucleus and faculties as orbital particles (p. 78); molecular- and weight-bondage liberation at constitutional

completeness (pp. 91, 117); human body as medium for awakening (p. 115); no isolated unit; development from environment (p. 230); humane behaviour as justice (p. 35); regulation through justice, *dharma*, and truth (p. 137); justice as recognition, fulfilment, evaluation, mutual satisfaction (pp. 311, 336); value taxonomy and civic values (p. 306); usefulness and aesthetic value, art (*kala*) (pp. 56–57, 324); four-fold human goal, awakened sociality, desire-trio, and restfulness as *abhyudaya* — resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, coexistence (p. 68); sovereignty, supreme order, and undivided society — universal orderliness (p. 28); family right-use as moral policy and security as state policy, basis of undivided society (pp. 74, 256); undivided society evidenced through science and wisdom (p. 210); five systems of universal orderliness and their success criteria (p. 260); fulfilment evidencing resolution and prosperity (p. 62); *kosha* sheath mapping of developmental layers — *pran kosha*, *vigyanmaya* (pp. 49–50).

- **SB** — Nagraj, A. *Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad (Resolution Centred Materialism)*. English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Also at https://www.youtube.com/playlist?list=PL69PCoz1OQWodhshZoXv3KtZ7ajJOIpgv (bilingual Hindi and English). Cited: unit wholeness with environment and orderliness with *ness* (p. 13); natural and excited state, conducive environment by order, insentient vs human excited-state contrast, development and decline (pp. 14–16); dialectical materialism vs Resolution Centred Materialism (pp. 8, 44); evidence through experimentation, behaviour, and experience (p. 44); existence as nature saturated in Omnipotence; matter/consciousness inseparability and coexistence (p. 48); timeless truth across three times (p. 48); Omnipotence all-pervasive and countless units (p. 49); complementarity from coexistence (p. 49); essentiality as value, reciprocity in mutuality (p. 50); nature embedded in complete, compulsory completeness, orientation toward development (pp. 50–51); telos: development and awakening until realisation in Omnipotence (p. 51); *ness* and exuberance under naturalness, seed germination illustration (p. 54); give–take reciprocity and *svabhav gati* (pp. 52–53); coexistence as essence and true form of complementarity (p. 53); complementarity in natural state, restfulness of effort (pp. 59–61); cyclical economics (p. 111); participation as recognising and fulfilling (p. 123); regulation as law, mutual recognition provision, regulation/activeness/forcefulness from saturation (p. 57); law of orderliness with *ness* and order conformance regimes (p. 236); effort–motion–result triad and sentient completeness mapping (pp. 58, 71); projection and reflection; *samadhan* (pp. 60, 64–65); three completeness types and developing solely for completeness (pp. 45, 51–52, 58, 80); physicochemical plane; atom vs molecule development (p. 52); constitutional completeness and quantitative stability (pp. 55, 59); identity-chain and basic impulsion (p. 62); inertial-impression (*adhyasa*) and *sanskar*-conformity (pp. 62–63); natural and excited state, assembly persistence (p. 14); layered order *dharmas* (p. 179); material-to-biological elevation, biological reversion, knowledge-order basis on Earth (pp. 76–78); statuses countable in development progression (p. 78); unit energy from saturation, forcefulness from saturation in formful units (pp. 57, 79); embedded inclination and mediative activity

toward completeness (p. 70); time measured by duration of activity (p. 65); humanly devised numerical reckoning of time (p. 251); state–motion inseparability and order-specific mutual activity (pp. 248–249); *jeevan* free from weight-bondage and molecular-bondage (p. 114); human dharma as undivided society and universal orderliness, family-based self-organising order to world family and order, sectarian to undivided-society consciousness (pp. 246–247).

- **JV** — Nagraj, A. *Jeevan Vidya: An Introduction*. English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: no provision to separate units from Omnipresence (p. 18); birth, death, conservation, and *jeevan* post-death continuity (p. 20); nothing isolated (p. 43); six-fold value comprehension — human, *jeevan*, established, and civic values (p. 43); human values through Jeevan Vidya (p. 44); order conformity and definite conduct (pp. 48, 113); universal recognition–fulfilment (p. 69); protected, regulated, energised at fundamental level (p. 82); atomic assembly and coexistence inclination (p. 67); cells to organisms (p. 82); incomplete knowledge order (p. 47); human body provisioned to evidence understanding (p. 59; §4); knowing and believing (p. 70); justice through relationships, values, evaluation, mutual satisfaction (p. 55); established values — care, guidance, trust, affection, gratitude, glory, love, reverence, respect (p. 108); five dimensions of undivided orderliness (p. 110); usefulness and aesthetic value; *jeevan* values and faculty harmonies (p. 138); object vs *jeevan*, human, and established values (p. 139); *jeevan* and human goals — resolution = happiness (p. 61); human goal — resolution, prosperity, fearlessness, coexistence (p. 165); prosperity through right-use production (p. 41); usefulness value in food chains (p. 77); nucleus and orbit activities of *jeevan* (p. 92); human body evidencing ten *jeevan* activities (pp. 79, 93).

Madhyasth Darshan (secondary exposition)

- **Bhattacharya** — Bhattacharya, S. *The Relationship of Jeevan and Brain*. Cited: brain versus *jeevan* and finer order map (§1.6).

Advaita Vedanta (primary texts)

Verse and section numbers follow standard numbering and apply to any faithful edition (e.g. Swami Gambhirananda's or Swami Madhavananda's translations, Advaita Ashrama).

- **TU** — *Taittiriya Upanishad*. Cited: Brahman as Truth, Knowledge, and Infinity (2.1.1); *anandamaya* passage (2.5).
- **CU** — *Chandogya Upanishad*. Cited: Existence alone, one without a second (6.2.1–6.2.2), with Shankara's commentary; clay and name-form (6.1.4) (§§2.1, 2.4).
- **MU** — *Mandukya Upanishad*. Cited: three states of consciousness (*avastha-traya*), vv. 3–7 (§2.2).
- **BG** — *Bhagavad Gita*, Shankara's commentary (Swami Gambhirananda). Cited: knower of the field (13.1–13.2) (§2.6); *loka-sangraha* and ordained duty (3.8) (§2.9).

- **VC** — *Vivekachudamani* (attributed to Shankara). English translation by Swami Madhavananda. Cited: Sat-Chit-Ananda (vv. 152, 217); ethical prerequisites (vv. 17–19); Brahman real / universe unreal (v. 20); *jiva* as Brahman (v. 216); Ishvara/Jiva superimpositions (v. 244); clay-jar analogy (v. 251); liberation without seeker/liberated (v. 574); changeless Self (v. 393); Pancha Kosha method (vv. 210, 639).
- **DDV** — *Drig-Drishya-Viveka* (attributed to Shankara or Bharati Tirtha). Cited: seer/seen discrimination (vv. 1–5) (§2.6, §3.2, §6.3).

Other Indian philosophies (external only)

- **Ishvarakrishna** — Ishvarakrishna. *Samkhyakarika*. Translated by Swami Virupakshananda. Cited: Prakriti and *parinamavada* (§5.4).
- **Nagarjuna** — Nagarjuna. *Mulamadhyamakakarika (Fundamental Verses on the Middle Way)*. Translated by Jay L. Garfield. Cited: *svabhava* critique, dependent origination, mutual dependence challenge (§6.2.2).
- **Anatta** — Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy. *Anatta (No Self)*. Cited: challenge to immortal distinct *jeevan* (§5.5, §6.2.2).

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